

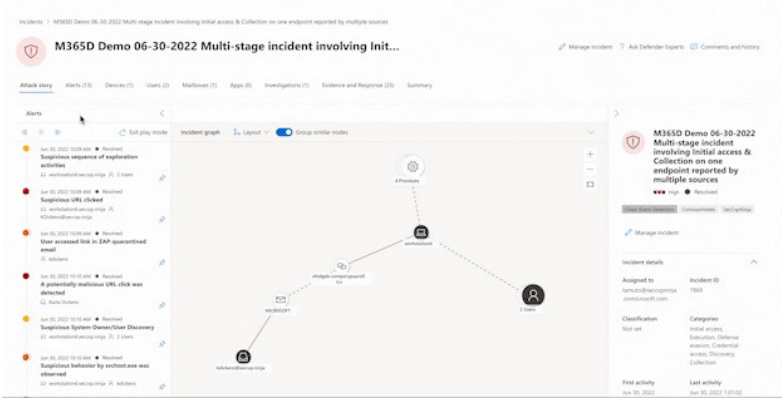
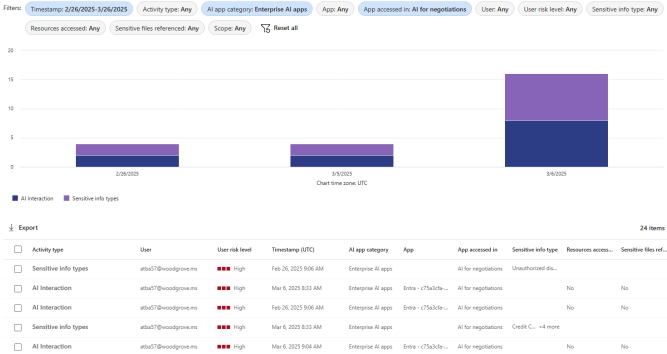
Project Atlas

Complete Visual Security Stack Portfolio

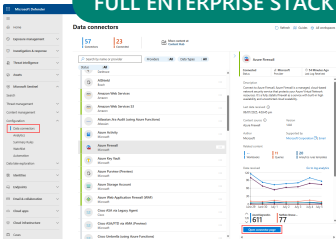
One incident. One protected data set. Every control has a distinct job.

Activity explorer

Review AI activity including AI interactions (prompts and responses), activity with sensitive info types, and more.

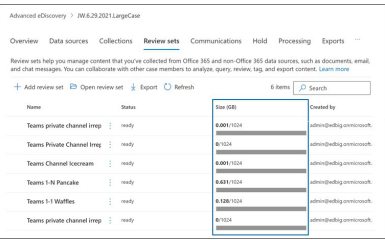


VISUAL EVIDENCE EDITION



FULL ENTERPRISE STACK

FICTIONAL ENTERPRISE LAB



What This Portfolio Demonstrates

The complete story is organized around one sensitive data set, not a collection of disconnected product screenshots.

PROJECT ATLAS

A phishing-driven account compromise becomes a sensitive-data exfiltration attempt.

Identity explains who. Endpoint explains how. Purview explains what data. XDR and Sentinel connect the story.

DATA

Azure SQL | Data Map | Fabric | Power BI

PROTECT

Labels | Publishing | DLP | Endpoint DLP

ACCESS

Entra | Conditional Access | Intune

DETECT

Defender Office | Endpoint | XDR | Cloud

CORRELATE

Sentinel | Hunting | Analytics | SOAR

PRESERVE

Audit | Insider Risk | eDiscovery | Retention

Evidence Standard - What the Screenshots Mean

The portfolio is intentionally explicit about proof, simulation, and recommended production validation.

BOUNDARY

This document demonstrates design and investigation reasoning. It does not assert a completed production deployment.

1

SUPPLIED SCREENSHOT

Portal images reproduced from the two PDFs supplied with this request. They are visual evidence examples, not a claim of live tenant execution.

2

SCENARIO ARTIFACT

Users, devices, file names, policy names, incident IDs, and outcomes belong to the fictional Contoso Meridian Financial lab.

3

DESIGN DECISION

Control settings, query logic, response gates, and RBAC are architecture choices to be validated against tenant licensing and current portal behavior.

4

PRODUCTION PROOF

A real deployment should retain dated exports, alert IDs, policy versions, timestamps, approvals, and post-containment checks.

What 'Full Microsoft Security Stack' Means Here

The portfolio covers the complete applicable enterprise stack and records conditional or non-applicable capabilities instead of manufacturing evidence.

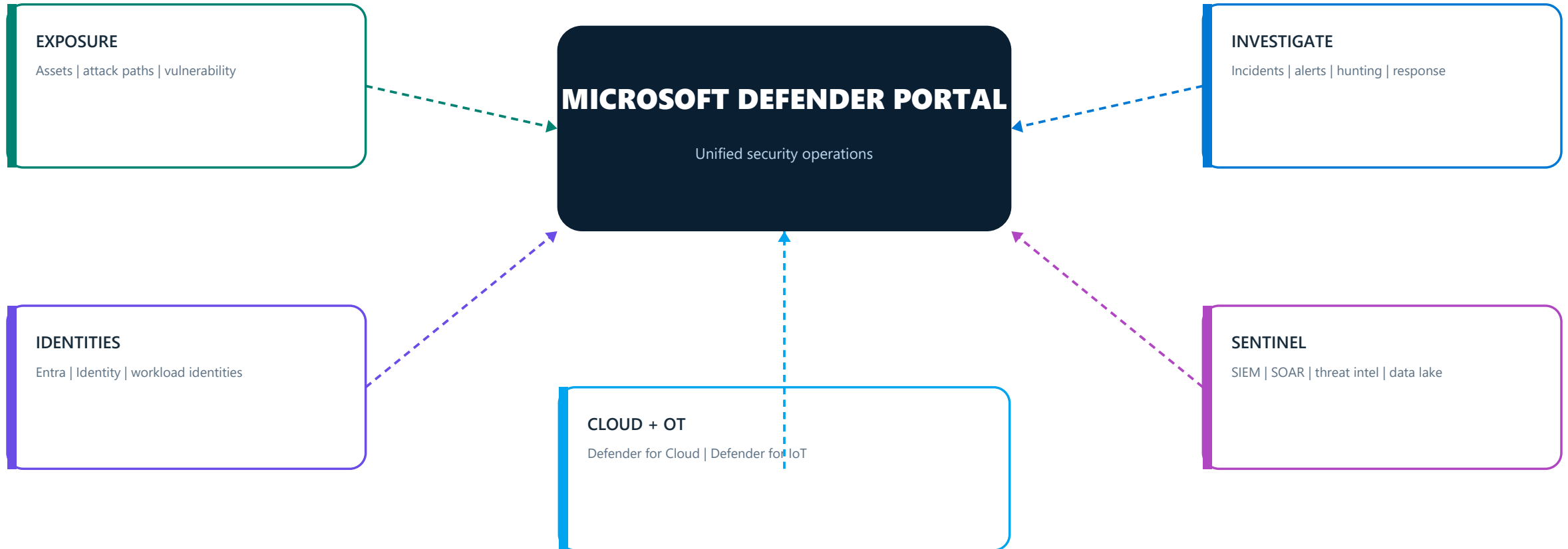
PLANE	CAPABILITIES	SCENARIO STATUS
Unified SecOps	Defender portal, Defender XDR, Sentinel, Threat Intelligence, Security Copilot	USED
Threat protection	Endpoint, Office 365, Identity, Cloud Apps, Vulnerability Management	USED
Cloud security	Defender for Cloud: CSPM, DevSecOps, and workload protection	USED
Identity + access	Entra ID, ID Protection, ID Governance, PIM, Workload ID, Global Secure Access	USED
Endpoint management	Intune, Windows security controls, Defender integration, compliance	USED
Data security	Purview governance, Information Protection, DLP, DSPM, investigations, IRM	USED
Compliance + legal	Audit, Communication Compliance, Information Barriers, Compliance Manager, eDiscovery, records	USED
OT / IoT	Defender for IoT applied only to the acquired company's manufacturing environment	CONDITIONAL

Full stack does not mean every product must generate an alert. Every applicable product needs a defined preventive, detective, response, or governance role.

Microsoft Defender Portal - The Operational Front Door

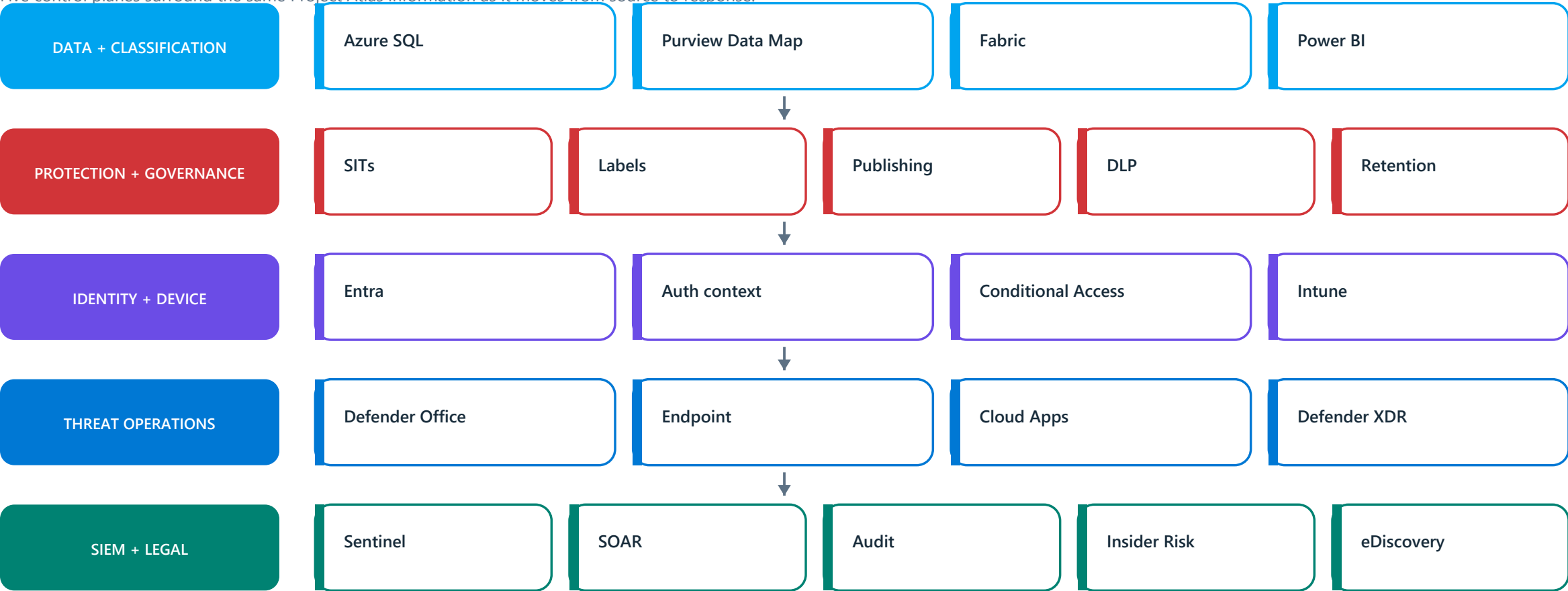
The unified portal brings pre-breach exposure and post-breach investigation into one operating model while the underlying services keep distinct responsibilities.

One portal experience does not erase product boundaries, permissions, licensing, or data ownership.



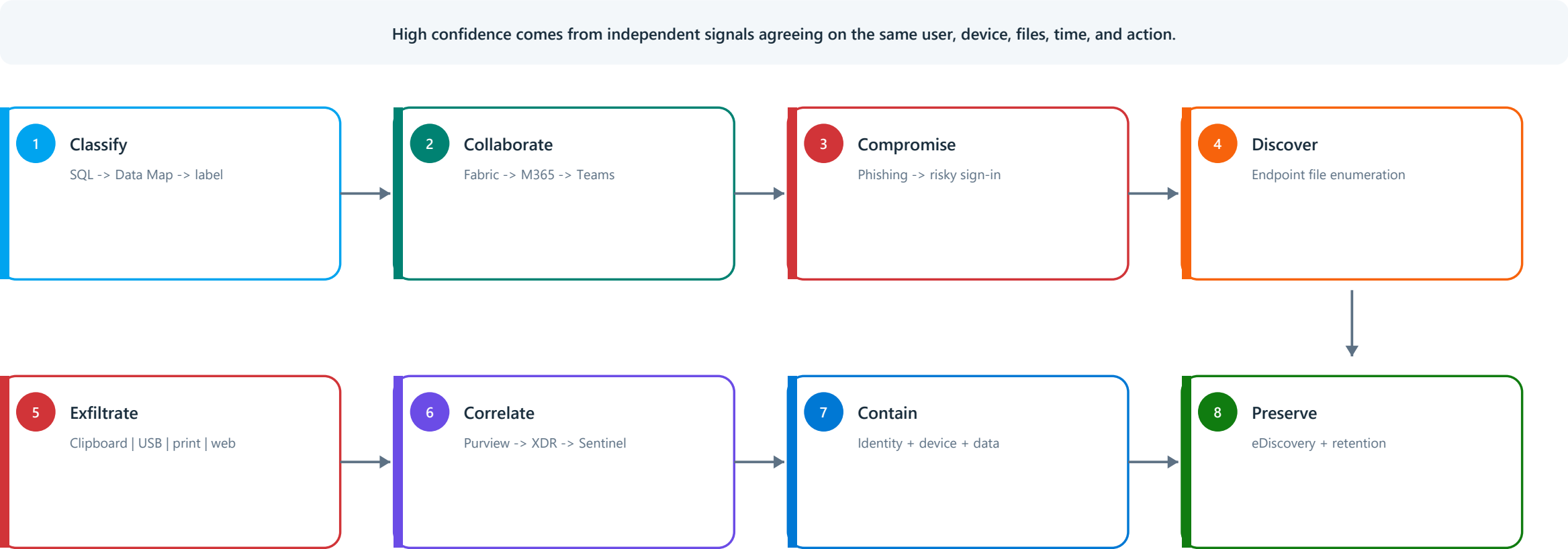
The Complete Microsoft Security Stack

Five control planes surround the same Project Atlas information as it moves from source to response.



One Incident Across the Stack

Each handoff adds a different fact: access, device state, data sensitivity, threat activity, or legal obligation.



Organization, Identity, and Protected Assets

The authorized business relationship is defined before the attacker takes control of the session.

ORGANIZATION

Contoso Meridian Financial
Project: acquisition of another company
Code name: PROJECT ATLAS

PRIMARY USER

Avery Cole
avery.cole@contosomeridian.com
Corporate Finance

DEVICE

CMF-FIN-042
Intune managed
Defender onboarded

COLLABORATION

M365 Group: Project Atlas
SharePoint: Project Atlas Acquisition
Teams: Project Atlas

HIGH-VALUE DATA

PII | SSNs | banking data
Valuations | contracts | legal
Security architecture | credentials

ACCESS PRINCIPLE

Avery needs financial analysis.
Avery is not entitled to privileged legal strategy.
Authorization remains content-specific.

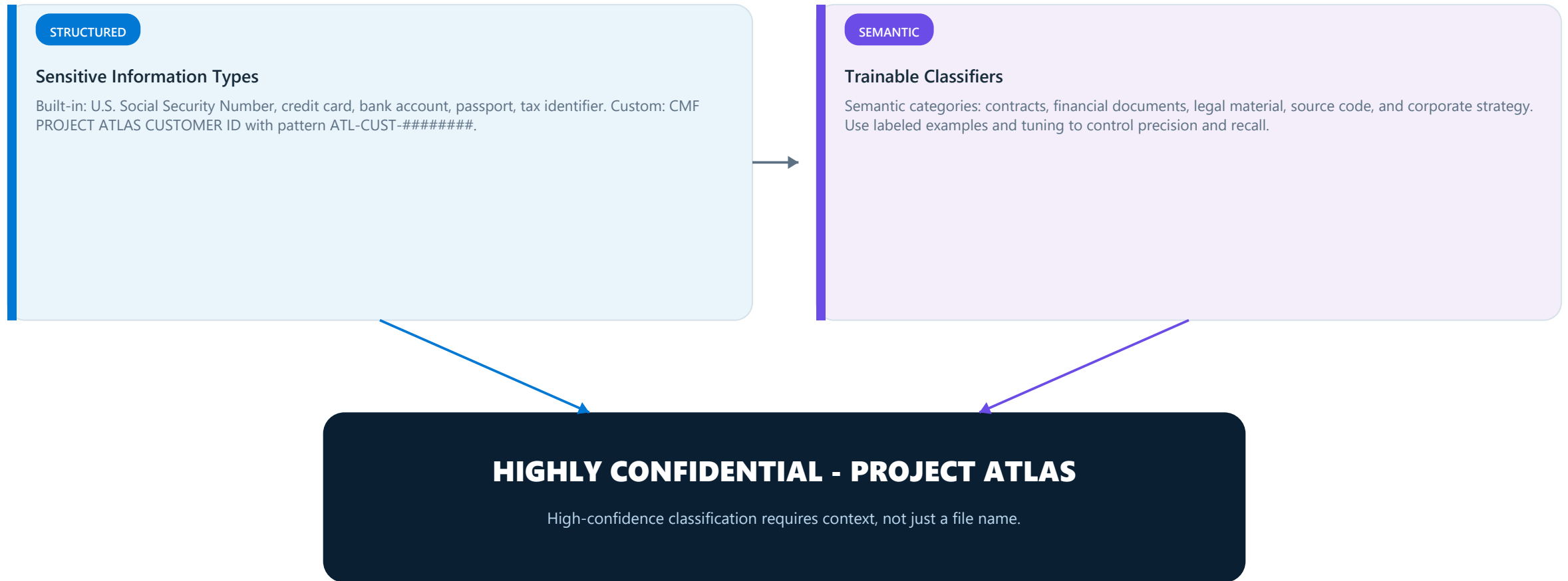
RBAC and Separation of Duties

Administrative configuration, alert triage, sensitive-content viewing, and legal preservation are intentionally separated.

PERSONA	PRIMARY RESPONSIBILITY	CONTROL BOUNDARY
Information Protection Admin	Labels, publishing, classification configuration	No standing content access
DLP Administrator	DLP policy and alert configuration	No legal case authority
Information Protection Analyst	Classification and policy review	Metadata-first
Content Explorer List Viewer	Locate classified items	Cannot inspect content
Content Explorer Content Viewer	Inspect content when authorized	Separate privileged role
Insider Risk Analyst / Investigator	Triage and investigate user risk	Privacy controls apply
Security Reader / Operator	Investigate and respond in Defender	Scoped operational access
Sentinel Responder	SIEM triage and approved playbooks	Response gates
eDiscovery Manager	Case, hold, search, review, export	Legal workflow

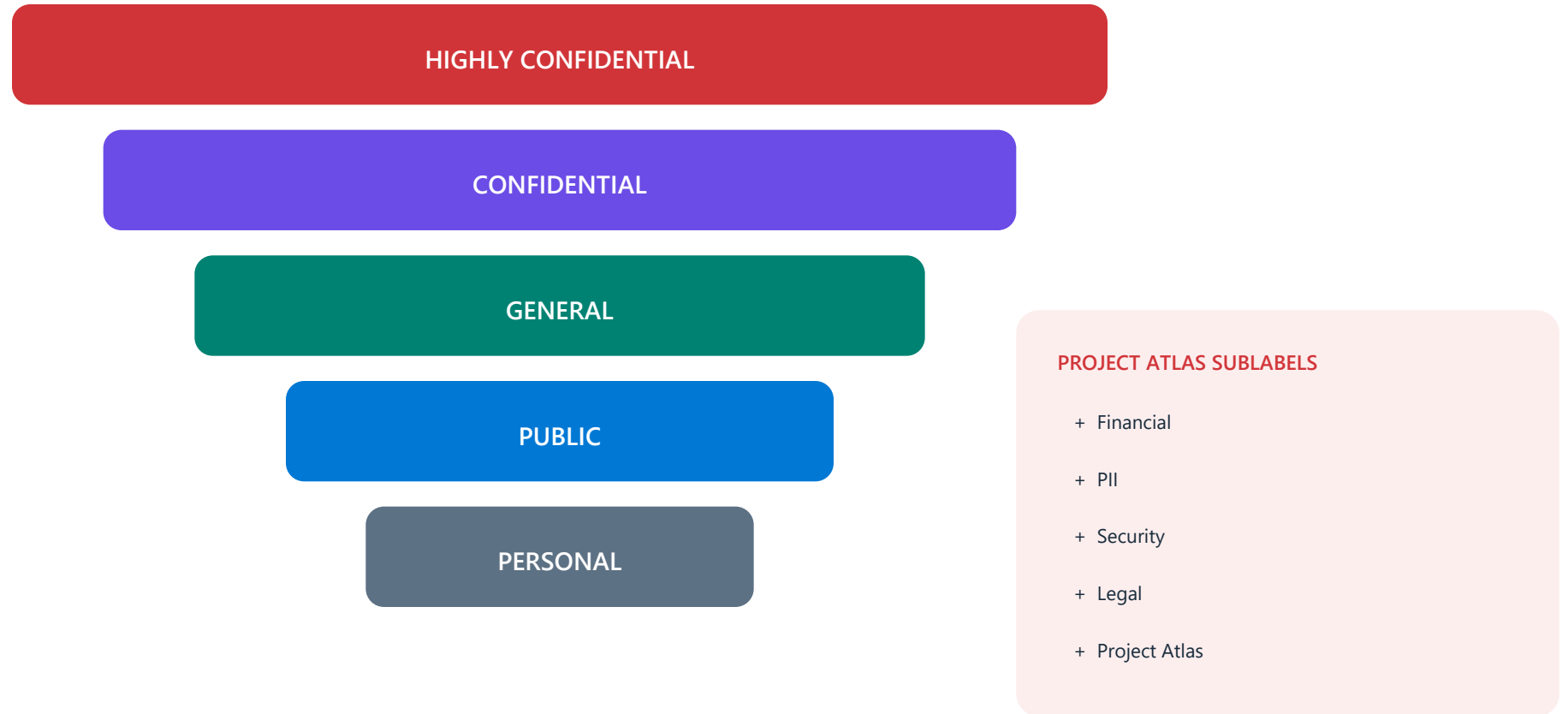
Structured + Semantic Detection

Project Atlas combines deterministic identifiers with document meaning so policy is not dependent on one signal.



Sensitivity Label Taxonomy

Priority increases with business and regulatory impact; sublabels expose only the classifications each department needs.



Label Scope - Files, Email, Meetings, Groups and Sites

The scope determines where a sensitivity label can be used and which protection settings are available.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Define the scope for this label

Labels can be applied to data assets and containers (like SharePoint sites and Teams). Let us know where you want this label to be used so we can show you the related protection settings. [Learn more about label scopes](#)

☒ **Files & other data assets**

Label files and data assets in Microsoft 365, Microsoft Fabric, Microsoft Azure, AWS and other platforms.

☒ **Emails**

Label messages sent from all versions of Outlook.

☒ **Meetings**

Label calendar events and meetings schedules in Outlook and Teams.

 Parent label will automatically inherit meeting scope from sub labels

☒ **Groups & sites**

Configure privacy, access control, and other settings to protect labeled Teams, Microsoft 365 Groups, and SharePoint sites.

 **Wondering where the schematized data assets option went?** To apply this label to data assets in non-Microsoft 365 sources like Azure, Amazon S3, Snowflake, and more, select "Files and other data assets" above and then add this label to an auto-labeling policy that's scoped to those non-Microsoft 365 data sources. [Learn more](#)

Supplied portfolio screenshot - sensitivity label scope example.

File and data scope

Extends classification to Microsoft 365 content and supported Fabric, Azure, and other data assets.

Container scope

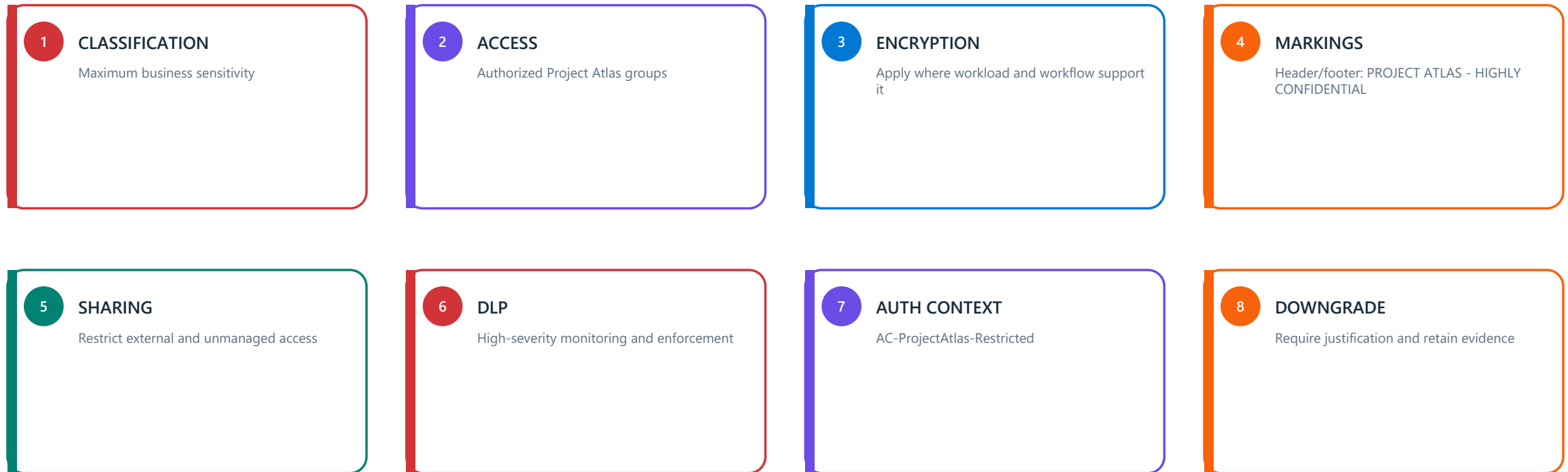
Groups and sites govern privacy, sharing, and access settings for Teams, Microsoft 365 Groups, and SharePoint.

Design control

A parent/sublabel model keeps Project Atlas usable without publishing every specialty label to every employee.

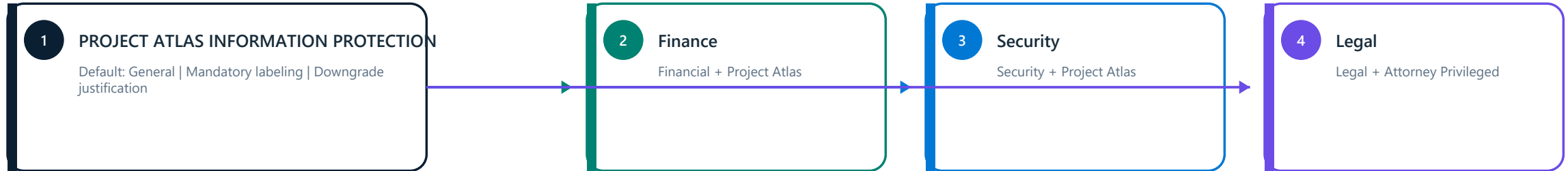
Highly Confidential - Project Atlas Protection Blueprint

The label is both a durable classification and a trigger for supported protection behavior.



Publishing Policy - The Label Must Reach the Right Users

Creating a label does not publish it. Policy assignment makes labels and policy settings available to selected users and groups.



Default label

General establishes a baseline; it does not replace classification logic.

Least exposure

Not every employee receives every sublabel.

Mandatory labeling

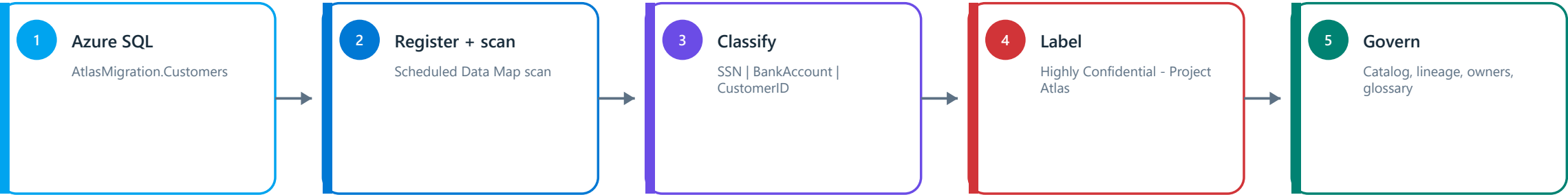
Supported workflows require a label before users complete sensitive work.

RBAC nuance

Some activation steps and content viewing require additional roles.

Azure SQL -> Purview Data Map -> Classified Columns

Information protection begins at the system of record, before data becomes an Office file.



COLUMN	CLASSIFICATION SIGNAL	SECURITY MEANING
CustomerID	ATL-CUST-#####	Organization-specific identity
SSN	U.S. Social Security Number	Regulated personal data
BankAccount	Bank account information	Financial data
AcquisitionValue	Financial / strategy context	Mission-critical transaction

Fabric and Power BI - Preserve Classification Through Analytics

The scenario follows the label into analytics and then into supported exported formats.



Supported-path principle

Label inheritance and protected exports depend on workload, tenant settings, permissions, connection mode, and supported export paths. Validate the exact path used in the lab.

Scenario artifact

Project_Atlas_Valuation.xlsx contains 2,500 customer identities, SSNs, banking details, projections, and acquisition valuation data.

Client-Side Auto-Labeling - User Decision Point

Office detects sensitive content while Avery is working and recommends the Project Atlas classification.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Auto-labeling for files and emails

When users edit Office files or compose, reply to, or forward emails from Outlook that contain content matching the conditions you choose here, we'll automatically apply this label or recommend that they apply it themselves. [Learn more about auto-labeling for Microsoft Purview](#)

To automatically apply this label to files that are already saved (in SharePoint and OneDrive) or emails that are already processed by Exchange, you must create an auto-labeling policy. [Learn more about auto-labeling policies](#)

Auto-labeling for files and emails

^ Detect content that matches these conditions

^ Content contains

Default

All of these ^

Add ^

Sensitive info types

Trainable classifiers

+ Add condition ^

Supplied portfolio screenshot - client-side auto-labeling condition example.

Initial state

Atlas_Customer_Review.xlsx begins with the General label.

Detection

Hundreds of Project Atlas IDs and regulated identifiers meet the configured condition.

Outcome

Avery accepts the recommendation; the applied label is recorded after save.

Marc Lavoie | Project Atlas | Microsoft Security Stack Visual Portfolio

Microsoft Learn: MS02 MS03

17

Service-Side Auto-Labeling - Simulate Before Enforcing

SharePoint and OneDrive content can be evaluated without requiring a user to open each file.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Decide if you want to test out the policy now or later

To help you determine whether the label will be applied to the correct items, you'll need to run the policy in simulation mode before turning it on. You can do this right away or wait until later.

☒ Run policy in simulation mode

We'll gather items that match the policy but labels won't be applied yet. It's highly recommended that you review these items to decide whether the policy needs to be refined or if it's ready to be turned on.

- ☒ Automatically turn on policy if not modified after 7 days in simulation.
The 7-day period will restart each time the policy is modified while in simulation.

☐ Leave policy turned off

Your settings will be saved, but the policy will be inactive until you run it in simulation mode and then turn it on.

Supplied portfolio screenshot - service-side auto-labeling simulation choice.

Simulation first

Review expected matches, false positives, sites, files, and confidence before enabling enforcement.

Policy match

2,500 SSNs + 2,500 custom Project Atlas IDs + financial information.

RBAC note

Turning a policy on after simulation can require roles beyond label configuration; validate current permissions.

Content Explorer - Classified Data Inventory

Investigators first locate sensitive content; viewing actual content remains a separately privileged action.

HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL - PROJECT ATLAS

- **SharePoint - Project Atlas Acquisition**
 - Atlas_Migration_Master.xlsx
 - Atlas_Valuation.xlsx
 - Acquisition_Strategy.docx
- **OneDrive - Avery Cole**
 - Atlas_Customer_Review.xlsx
- **Exchange - Project Atlas messages**

METADATA

List Viewer

Can identify items, locations, labels, and sensitive-information categories without opening the content.

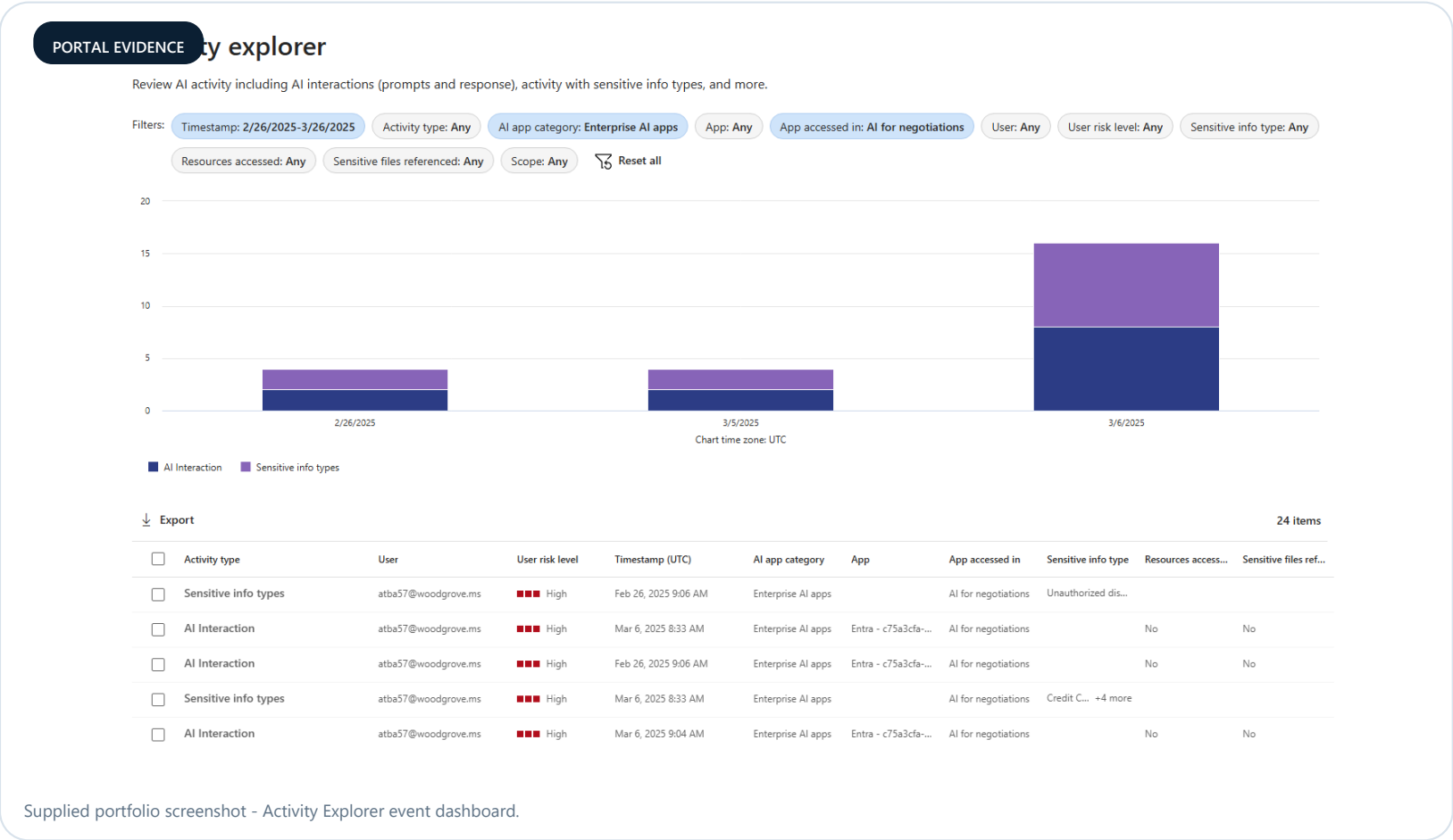
PRIVILEGED

Content Viewer

Can inspect the underlying item only when separately authorized and when the investigation requires it.

Activity Explorer - Label and DLP Activity

The data-security timeline connects label application, downgrades, file actions, and DLP matches.



Supplied portfolio screenshot - Activity Explorer event dashboard.

Label events

Applied, changed, removed, and supported read events can be filtered for the Project Atlas label.

Endpoint events

Clipboard, print, removable storage, browser, and restricted-app activity add handling context.

Investigator question

Did the risky action occur before or after the identity and endpoint alerts?

SharePoint / Teams Container Label + Entra Authentication Context

File labels protect individual content; container labels govern the collaboration environment.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Conditional Access Policy details

↑ Previous ↓ Next

Policy: Strict Location CA Policy

Policy state: Enabled

Result: Failure

Assignments

User

Anna Traver

✓ Matched

Application

Office 365 Exchange Online

✓ Matched

Conditions

Sign-in risk

None

● Not configured

Device platform

Windows 10

● Not configured

Location

Quincy, US

✓ Matched

Location included

IP seen by Azure AD

51.143.90.94

✗ Not matched

IP seen by resource provider

73.193.97.10

✓ Matched

Client app

Browser

● Not configured

Device

Unknown

● Not configured

User risk

● Not configured

Access controls

Grant Controls

✗ Block

Block

Session Controls

✓ Enforced

ContinuousAccessEvaluation

Supplied portfolio screenshot - SharePoint label and authentication-context configuration.

Container controls

Restrict external sharing, guests, privacy, and unmanaged-device access for the Project Atlas site/team.

Authentication context

AC-ProjectAtlas-Restricted links the high-value resource to a dedicated Conditional Access decision.

Important distinction

A site label does not replace file-level classification, encryption, or DLP.

Intune Compliance in the Access Chain

Device posture becomes an access signal only when the compliance policy and Conditional Access grant controls are configured.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Microsoft Intune admin center

Dashboard > Devices

Devices | Compliance

Search

Overview

All devices

Monitor

By platform

Windows

iOS/iPadOS

macOS

Android

Linux

Device onboarding

Windows 365

Enrollment

Manage devices

Configuration

Compliance

Conditional access

Policies

Notifications

Retire noncompliant devices

Compliance settings

Scripts

Monitor

One or more compliance policies for iOS/iPadOS have a configured Device Threat Level setting without an active Mobile Threat Defense connector. Click here to setup a Mobile Threat Defense connector for iOS/iPadOS.

+ Create policy

Refresh

Export

Columns

32 policies

Search

Add filters

Policy name	Platform or OS	Policy type	Last modified	Scope tags
MDM CA	iOS/iPadOS	iOS compliance policy	06/02/2023 12:24 PM	Yes

Supplied portfolio screenshot - Intune device compliance view.

Expected posture

CMF-FIN-042 is managed, encrypted, healthy, and Defender-integrated before the incident.

Signal path

Intune evaluates compliance and sends status to Microsoft Entra for the access decision.

Failure mode

An attacker from an unmanaged device cannot satisfy the Project Atlas context, even with stolen credentials.

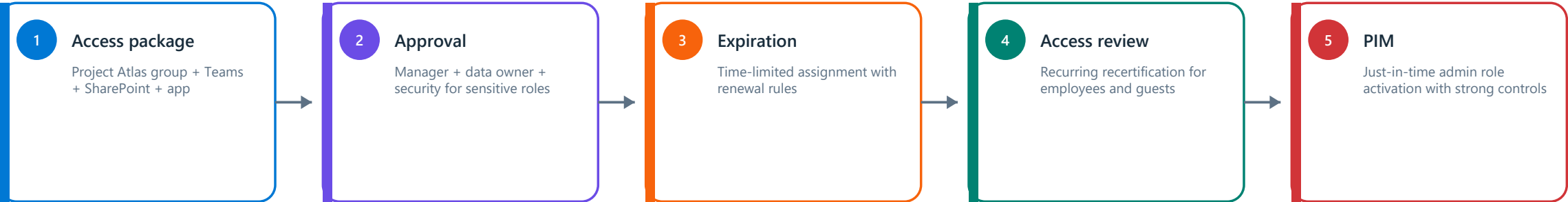
Marc Lavoie | Project Atlas | Microsoft Security Stack Visual Portfolio

Microsoft Learn: MS10

22

Entra ID Governance + PIM - Access Before the Incident

Project membership and administrative privilege are time-bound, approved, reviewable, and removable when the acquisition work ends.



Incident use

Review Avery's access-package assignment, group changes, privileged activations, access-review decisions, and any guest or administrator changes during the incident window.

Post-incident use

Remove stale access, force a Project Atlas recertification, shorten assignment duration, and require PIM activation for label, DLP, and eDiscovery administration.

External ID + Workload ID + Global Secure Access

The scenario protects people, guests, service principals, automation, and private resources - not only Avery's workforce identity.

Investigation pivots: guest invitation, app consent, service-principal sign-in, credential age, private-app access, and internet destination logs.

1

External collaboration

Use governed B2B/external identities for outside counsel and acquisition advisers; place them in time-limited access packages.

2

Workload identities

Use managed identities or federation for Fabric pipelines and playbooks; avoid embedded secrets and review service-principal privileges.

3

Internet Access

Apply identity-aware secure web gateway and web filtering to public internet and SaaS traffic where licensed and deployed.

4

Private Access

Use identity-centric ZTNA for private acquisition applications instead of broad network-level remote access.

Microsoft Entra Family - Capability and Applicability Map

The identity plane covers workforce, guests, workloads, agents, legacy services, credentials, and network access with explicit scenario status.

ENTRA PRODUCT	PROJECT ATLAS ROLE	STATUS
Entra ID	Authentication, groups, apps, devices, Conditional Access	USED
ID Protection	Risky users, risky sign-ins, risk-based policy	USED
ID Governance / PIM	Access packages, reviews, lifecycle, just-in-time privilege	USED
External ID	Outside counsel and partner collaboration	USED
Workload ID	Fabric pipelines, playbooks, service principals, managed identities	USED
Internet / Private Access	Identity-aware SWG and ZTNA for public/private resources	USED IF LICENSED
Agent ID	Govern AI agent identities and sponsored access	CONDITIONAL / PREVIEW
Verified ID	Verifiable credentials for high-assurance external workflows	OPTIONAL
Domain Services	Managed LDAP/Kerberos/NTLM for a legacy acquisition app	CONDITIONAL

Windows Security + Intune + Defender for Endpoint

The endpoint story includes prevention, configuration, detection, response, and recovery - not EDR alone.

Accuracy rule: record each control's actual mode and state. 'Configured' is not the same as 'triggered,' and 'detected' is not the same as 'blocked.'

1 Hardware + identity

TPM | Secure Boot | Windows Hello for Business | Credential Guard

2 Data at rest

BitLocker encryption with managed recovery-key process

3 Attack prevention

Defender Antivirus | SmartScreen | network protection | ASR rules

4 Application control

App Control for Business / controlled application trust

5 Management

Intune security baselines, endpoint security policy, compliance, and configuration

6 Detection + response

Defender for Endpoint EDR, AIR, device isolation, investigation package

Microsoft Intune - Device, App, Privilege, and Certificate Controls

Intune supplies the management plane that makes endpoint and access policies repeatable across corporate and mobile devices.

Incident evidence: device compliance history, policy assignment, configuration conflicts, app-protection result, elevation event, certificate, and remote-help audit.

1 Enrollment + inventory

Corporate ownership, platform, hardware, installed apps, and management state

2 Compliance

Encryption, OS level, threat level, password, and custom compliance signals

3 Configuration

Security baselines, settings catalog, update rings, and configuration profiles

4 App protection

MAM data-transfer, save-as, copy/paste, and conditional-launch controls

5 Endpoint Privilege Management

Standard-user operation with scoped, audited elevation where deployed

6 Certificates + remote support

Cloud PKI/certificate delivery and governed Remote Help where licensed

Teams, Microsoft 365 Copilot, and Retention

The same content has separate access, protection, collaboration, and lifecycle controls.



Protection question

How should this information be protected right now? Labels, encryption, DLP, access, and content markings answer this.

Lifecycle question

How long must the record be kept, when may it be deleted, and does a legal hold override normal disposition?

Defender for Office 365 - Establish Initial Access

The investigation starts with the suspicious message and its delivery, click, URL, and remediation evidence.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Timeline

Analysis

Attachments

URL

Similar emails

Threat detection details

Threats	Confidence Level	Priority account protection	Detection technology
Phish ☒ Primary threat	High	No	URL detonation reputation

Email detection details

Sender-Recipient details

Authentication

Related entities

Plain-text email header

To

Cc

Copy the message header below and paste it into the Message Header Analyzer tool to review and analyze detailed transport information about the message.[Learn about this tool](#)

[Microsoft Message Header Analyzer](#)

Copy message header

ARC-Seal: i=2; a=rsa-sha256;
s=arcselector9901; d=fabrikam.com; cv=pass
b=IkwmzjsIXPuTdr/VZnyb2A7JGkk6qUa8jfKZn67xNilbNPNs+
+COyDQhO31T+Nlo+I7jvm6zAUT+i2rB9k1X2jHVFYPdmYy2MI9Eu8R43I+
Sds6cvhdFrHGBjFdmBIK/
qCIZbxwJOa2FSQII2ZUeuA4aO2FU46MkEzTMcmd7Q0PytOaOHT7NE6yfl
SxUbqf6iO1DjEjWNkL8N5kgmSHvHmdPffvm7U0R8W7oCMJI6O5RD7cj
Qq6gqbKdWLZH6DCVdQ+GlmgopwGvtFluRx4BLXWK9aNZ/
aqP+RQZurtgCoqZGgFmN0nbZHh2PKrjVcOUO2UY/
knQM8YDFBttOEwdA==
ARC-Message-Signature: i=2; a=rsa-sha256; c=relaxed/relaxed;
d=fabrikam.com;
s=arcselector9901;
h=From:Date:Subject:Message-ID:Content-Type:MIME-Version:X-MS-

Supplied portfolio screenshot - Defender for Office 365 email entity example.

Message

From
executive-review@contoso-meridian-security.example
with an urgent valuation-corrections lure.

Analyst pivot

Validate sender, recipient, URL, delivery location, click
evidence, and related-message clusters.

Decision

Email evidence establishes the likely initial-access path; it
does not alone prove data loss.

Microsoft Threat Intelligence - Enrich the Phishing Infrastructure

Threat intelligence adds reputation, infrastructure relationships, campaigns, malware context, and analyst reports to the email and web indicators.



Project Atlas query

Investigate executive-review@contoso-meridian-security.example and the landing URL for newly registered infrastructure, linked certificates, hosting relationships, and prior observations.

Evidence boundary

Reputation and attribution are context. Preserve the observed tenant telemetry that ties the indicator to Avery's message, click, process, or connection.

Microsoft Entra ID Protection - Risky Identity Pivot

A sign-in anomaly adds identity context after the phishing event and before sensitive-data access.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Identity

Overview

Users

Groups

Devices

Applications

Protection

Identity governance

External Identities

Show more

Protection

Identity Protection

Conditional Access

Authentication methods

Password reset

Home > Identity Protection

Identity Protection | Risky users

Search

Learn moreDownloadSelect allConfirm user(s) compromisedDismiss user(s) risk

Dashboard

Overview

Tutorials

Diagnose and solve problems

Protect

Conditional Access

User risk policy

Sign-in risk policy

Multifactor authentication registration policy

Report

Risky users

Risky workload identities

Risky sign-ins

Risk detections

We recommend migrating Identity Protection policies to Conditional Access for more conditions and controls. Learn more

Get help investigating a risky user with Copilot. Select a user to get started.

Auto refresh : OffShow dates as : LocalRisk state : 2 selectedStatus : Active

Risk level : High, MediumAdd filters

User	Risk state	Risk last updated
Giovanna Costa	At risk	3/26/2024, 4:06:02 PM
Ratih Winata	At risk	3/26/2024, 11:31:01 AM
Sascha Lange	At risk	3/26/2024, 7:21:32 AM

Supplied portfolio screenshot - Entra risky-users investigation view.

Entity

avery.cole@contosomeridian.com becomes the shared user pivot across the incident.

Questions

Was the source unfamiliar? Was strong authentication satisfied? Did device, location, or risk change?

Evidence standard

Identity risk is supporting evidence, not proof of intent or exfiltration by itself.

Conditional Access Intervenes

The direct attacker session cannot satisfy the high-value resource requirements, but the compromised workstation remains a path.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Conditional Access Policy details

↑ Previous ↓ Next

Policy: Strict Location CA Policy

Policy state: Enabled

Result: Failure

Assignments

User

Anna Traver

Matched

Application

Office 365 Exchange Online

Matched

Conditions

Sign-in risk

None

Not configured

Device platform

Windows 10

Not configured

Location

Quincy, US

Matched

Location included

IP seen by Azure AD

51.143.90.94

Not matched

IP seen by resource provider

73.193.97.10

Matched

Client app

Browser

Not configured

Device

Unknown

Not configured

User risk

Not configured

Access controls

Grant Controls

Block

Block

Session Controls

Enforced

ContinuousAccessEvaluation

Supplied portfolio screenshot - Conditional Access policy configuration example.

Evaluate

Identity + authentication strength + sign-in risk + device compliance + authentication context.

Direct attempt

Unmanaged attacker environment is blocked or challenged for Project Atlas SharePoint.

Residual risk

The attacker controls Avery's already authenticated managed endpoint; endpoint controls now matter.

Defender for Endpoint + XDR - Suspicious Workstation Activity

CMF-FIN-042 becomes the attacker's route to synchronized OneDrive and locally available Project Atlas files.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Incidents

M365D Demo 06-30-2022 Multi-stage incident involving initial access & Collection on one endpoint reported by multiple sources

M365D Demo 06-30-2022 Multi-stage incident involving Init...

Manage incident

Ask Defender Experts

Comments and history

Attack story

Alerts (13)

Devices (7)

Users (2)

Mailboxes (1)

Apps (0)

Investigations (7)

Evidence and Response (25)

Summary

Alerts

Jun 30, 2022 10:09 AM

Resolved

Suspicious sequence of exploration activities

workstation@secexp.ninja

2 Users

Jun 30, 2022 10:09 AM

Resolved

Suspicious URL clicked

workstation@secexp.ninja

KDickers@secexp.ninja

Jun 30, 2022 10:09 AM

Resolved

User accessed link in ZAP-quantized email

kdickers

Jun 30, 2022 10:10 AM

Resolved

A potentially malicious URL click was detected

Karla Dickers

Jun 30, 2022 10:10 AM

Resolved

Suspicious System Owner/User Discovery

workstation@secexp.ninja

2 Users

Jun 30, 2022 10:10 AM

Resolved

Suspicious behavior by zncraft.exe was observed

workstation@secexp.ninja

kdickers

Incident graph

Layout

Group similar nodes

4 Processes

workstation

shelby@compagnypartail

Microsoft

kdickers@secexp.ninja

2 Users

M365D Demo 06-30-2022 Multi-stage incident involving initial access & Collection on one endpoint reported by multiple sources

High

Resolved

Chain Event Detection

Continuous Models

See Capabilities

Manage incident

Incident details

Assigned to

tamuto@secexp.ninja

com.microsoft.com

Incident ID

7369

Classification

Not set

Categories

Initial access, Execution, Defense evasion, Credential access, Discovery, Collection

First activity

Jun 30, 2022

Last activity

Jun 30, 2022 1:01:02

Supplied portfolio screenshot - Defender XDR incident attack story.

Observed

Suspicious process behavior and document enumeration around the compromised session.

Files

Atlas_Customer_Review.xlsx, Atlas_Valuation.xlsx, Acquisition_Strategy.docx, and Network_Integration_Plan.pdf.

Containment option

Isolate the device after analyst approval, preserve evidence, and collect an investigation package.

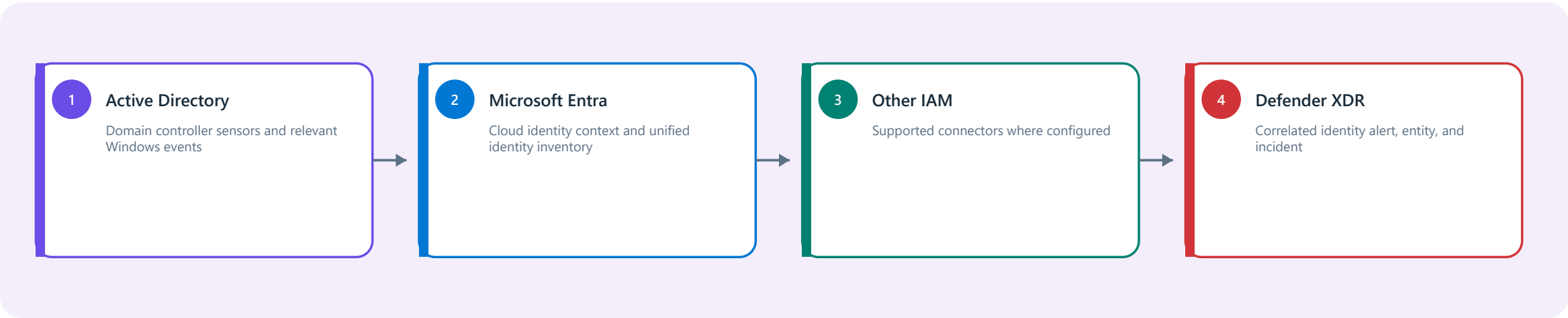
Marc Lavoie | Project Atlas | Microsoft Security Stack Visual Portfolio

Microsoft Learn: MS15 MS22

33

Defender for Identity - Hybrid Identity Attack Evidence

If Project Atlas users or acquisition systems rely on on-premises or hybrid identity, Defender for Identity covers reconnaissance, credential abuse, and lateral-movement signals.



QUESTION	EVIDENCE TO SEEK	PROJECT ATLAS DECISION
Reconnaissance?	Directory queries, unusual enumeration, sensor alerts	Did the attacker map privileged paths?
Credential abuse?	Abnormal authentication and service-account use	Was a second identity compromised?
Lateral movement?	Identity/device relationships and suspicious activity	Did impact extend beyond CMF-FIN-042?

Defender for Cloud Apps - Session, SaaS, and OAuth Control

Cloud Apps adds CASB, SSPM, behavioral analytics, Conditional Access App Control, and app governance to the Project Atlas story.

Project Atlas focus: unmanaged-session download controls, suspicious cloud activity, new OAuth grants, and app access to SharePoint/OneDrive data.

1 Cloud discovery

Identify sanctioned and unsanctioned SaaS usage

2 Session control

Monitor or block downloads, cut/copy, and print on risky sessions

3 File governance

Find sensitive cloud files and remove external collaborators

4 App governance

Investigate OAuth permissions, app behavior, and data access

5 SSPM

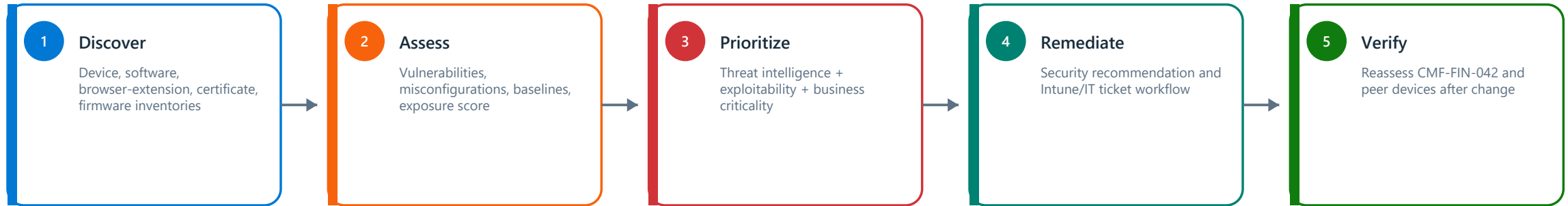
Review SaaS configuration posture and recommendations

6 XDR integration

Correlate cloud activities and app alerts with the incident

Defender Vulnerability Management - Find the Weakness the Attacker Used

Post-incident remediation includes the endpoint's software, configuration, certificates, extensions, exposure score, and tracked remediation work.



Root-cause question

Did an exploitable browser, Office, plug-in, credential-protection, or endpoint configuration weakness contribute to initial access or execution?

Portfolio evidence

Capture the recommendation, affected-device count, threat context, remediation owner, due date, exception, and post-fix assessment.

Microsoft Security Exposure Management - Protect the Critical Asset Path

The exposure graph connects identities, devices, cloud resources, SaaS, external assets, and attack paths before an incident occurs.



Pre-breach use

Mark Project Atlas assets as critical, review exposure initiatives, attack paths, choke points, and internet-facing resources.

Post-breach use

Validate whether the observed attacker path matches a known exposure path and close the systemic weakness, not only the alert.

Microsoft Defender for Cloud - CNAPP for Project Atlas Workloads

Defender for Cloud applies CSPM, DevSecOps, and workload protection to the Azure and multicloud systems that store or process Project Atlas data.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Microsoft Defender for Cloud | Overview

Showing 59 subscriptions

Search (Ctrl+/)

Subscriptions

What's new

General

Overview

Getting started

Recommendations

Security alerts

Inventory

Community

Cloud Security

Secure Score

Regulatory compliance

Workload protections

Firewall Manager

Management

Environment settings

Security solutions

Workflow automation

Azure subscriptions 59

AWS accounts 1

GCP projects 4

Active recommendations 161

Security alerts 121

Secure score

Current secure score

60% 3626 POINTS

COMPLETED Controls 1/16

COMPLETED Recommendations 29/190

Improve your secure score >

Regulatory compliance

Current compliance by passed controls

UKO and U... 0/7

SOC TSP 1/13

NIST SP 80... 2/23

HIPAA HITR... 2/22

NIST SP 80... 3/29

Improve your compliance >

Workload protections

Resource coverage 95%

For full protection, enable 10 resource plans

Alerts by severity

High 29

Med 66

Low 26

Enhance your threat protection capabilities >

Inventory

Unmonitored VMs 60

To better protect your organization, we recommend installing agents

Total Resources 3900

Unhealthy (2936) Healthy (679) Not applicable (285)

Explore your resources >

Supplied Security Operations portfolio screenshot - Defender for Cloud security-alert overview.

CSPM

Assess Azure SQL, storage, Key Vault, network, identity, and configuration posture; prioritize critical resources.

CWPP

Use the applicable Defender plans for servers, databases, storage, containers, APIs, and other workloads.

DevSecOps

Surface code-to-cloud risks and prevent insecure infrastructure or secrets from reaching production.

Azure Native Security - Network, Secrets, Policy, and Data Services

Defender for Cloud supplies posture and threat protection; Azure services enforce the architecture and generate the underlying control-plane and network evidence.

Project Atlas validation: private SQL access, no public exposure, managed identity for pipelines, protected secrets, complete diagnostics, and tested recovery.

1 Identity + secrets

Managed identities, Key Vault, RBAC, least privilege, rotation, and diagnostic logs

2 Network

Private endpoints, NSGs, Azure Firewall, WAF, DDoS protection, DNS, and flow evidence

3 Data

Azure SQL controls, encryption, auditing, Defender for SQL, and storage protection

4 Governance

Management groups, Azure Policy, resource locks, tags, and activity logs

5 Monitoring

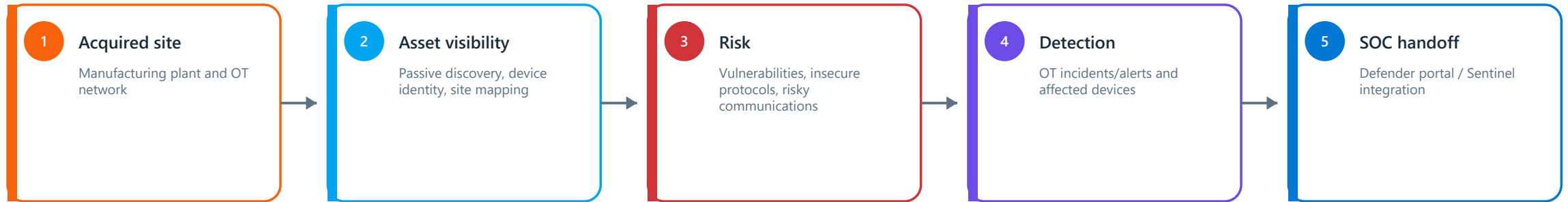
Azure Monitor, Log Analytics, diagnostics, alerts, and Sentinel ingestion

6 Recovery

Backups, immutability where required, key recovery, and tested restoration

Defender for IoT - Acquired Manufacturing Environment

Project Atlas includes a target company with operational technology. Defender for IoT establishes whether the finance compromise affected OT/IoT assets.



Scenario result

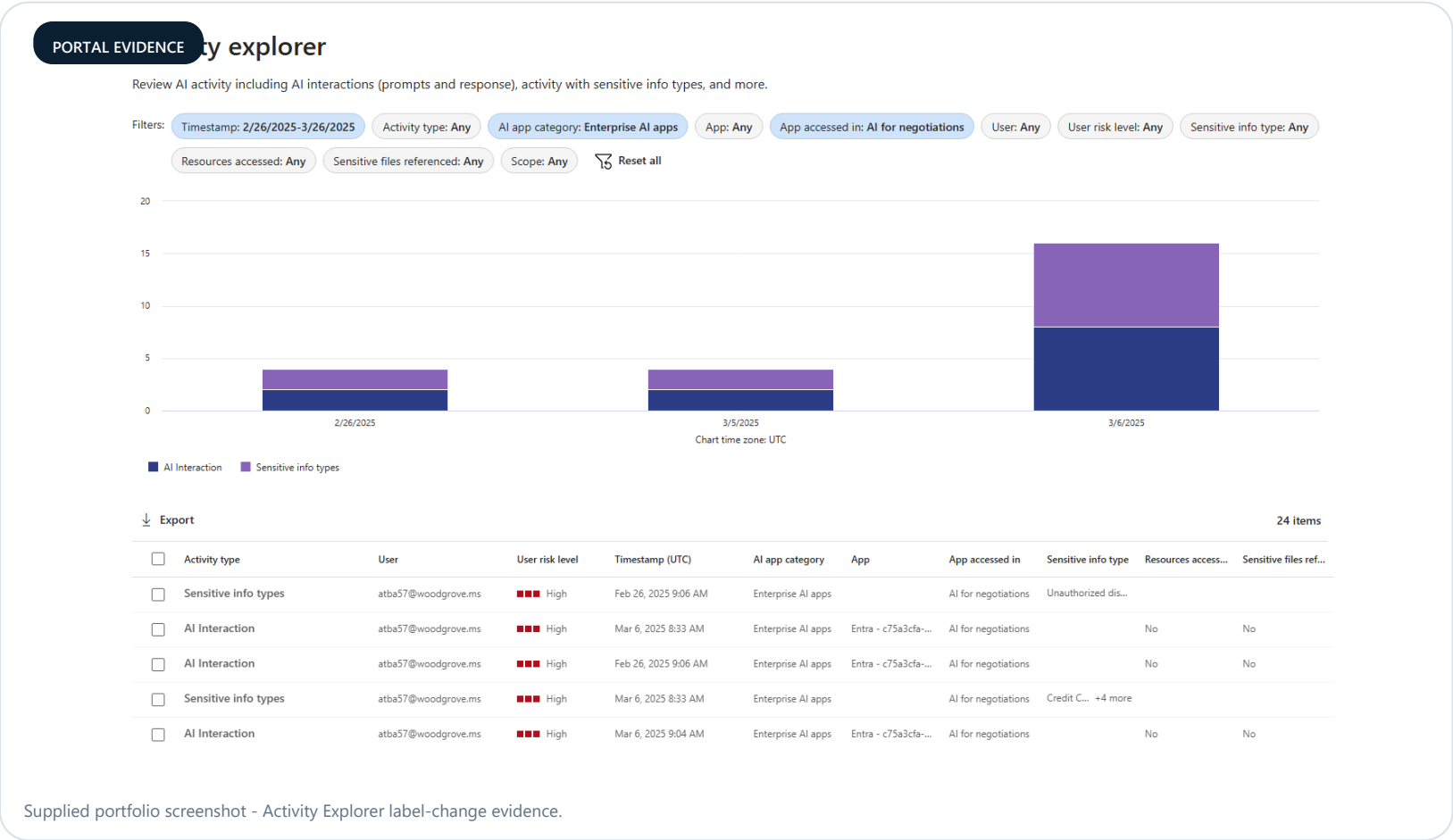
No evidence connects Avery's compromise to an OT device or production site. The control is used to establish the boundary and avoid an unsupported impact claim.

Accuracy note

The Defender-portal OT experience and some site-security capabilities may be preview. Record portal, sensor, license, and feature status in the lab.

Sensitivity Label Downgrade Attempt

The classification change becomes high-value evidence because of what happened immediately before and after it.



Change

Highly Confidential - Project Atlas -> General.

Justification

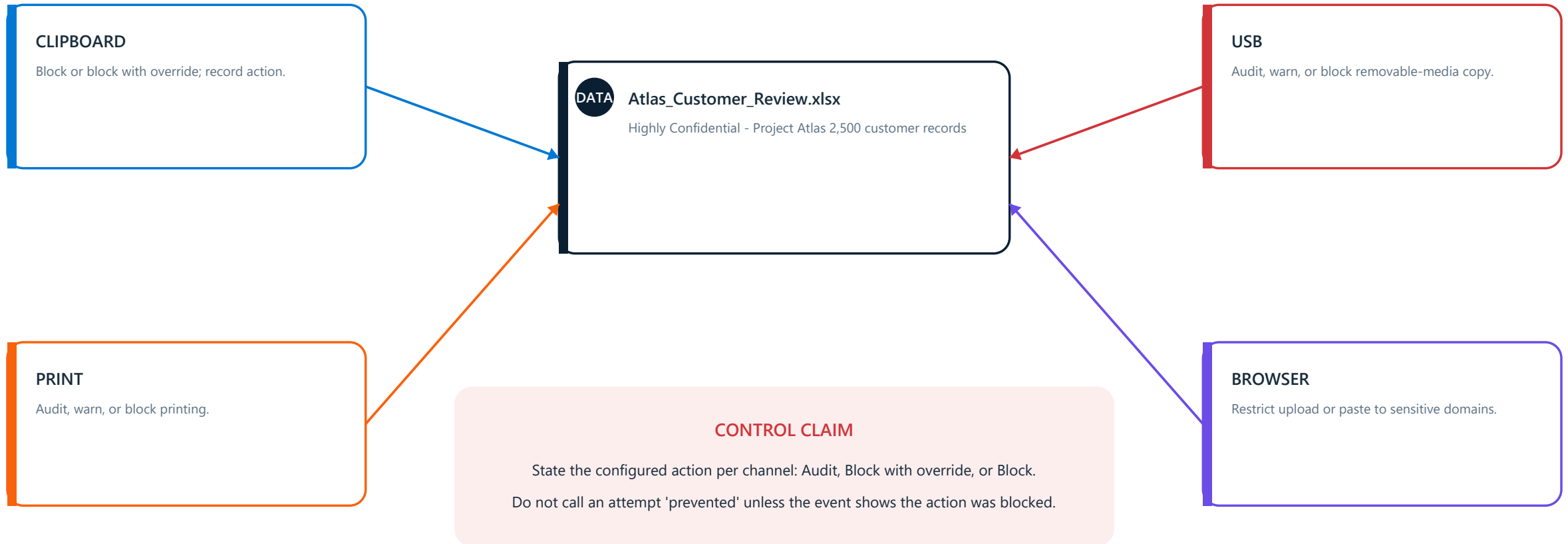
'File no longer contains sensitive information.' Capture the text, actor, device, time, and prior label.

Interpretation

A downgrade is not automatically malicious; correlate it with identity, endpoint, and exfiltration activity.

Four Exfiltration Paths - One Protected File

Endpoint DLP evaluates the action, source, destination, user, device, and content match for each channel.



Purview DLP Alert - Sensitive Data at Risk

DLP supplies the data context that email, identity, and endpoint telemetry cannot provide alone.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Incident reports

Use this severity level in admin alerts and reports:

Medium

Send an alert to admins when a rule match occurs.

On

Send email alerts to these people

admin@.com

Add or remove people

Send alert every time an activity matches the rule

Send alert when the volume of matched activities reaches a threshold

Instances more than or equal to

25

matched activities

Volume more than or equal to

0

MB

During the last

60

minutes

For

All users

Use email incident reports to notify you when a policy match occurs.

Off

Supplied portfolio screenshot - DLP alert policy-match detail.

Policy

PROJECT ATLAS HIGHLY CONFIDENTIAL DATA EXFILTRATION.

Evidence

File, user, device, destination, sensitive information types, rule, action, and event history.

Disposition

High-severity alert; confirm which transfers were attempted, allowed, overridden, or blocked.

Microsoft Purview Audit - Reconstruct the Chronology

Audit turns user and service actions into a defensible sequence for security and legal review.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Search Query Information: Sun, 04 Jun 2023 00:30:00 GMT to Sun, 11 Jun 2023 02:00:00 GMT ,

Total Result Count: 2928338 items

Export

300 items Filter

Date (UTC) ↓	IP Address	User	Record type	Activity	Item	Admin Units (Preview)	Details
Jun 11, 2023 1:41 AM		ADMIN@EDISCOS...	ComplianceDLPSharePoint	Matched DLP rule	ffd39aaf-2c77-4ca8-a02f-ed...		
Jun 10, 2023 10:33 PM		SecurityComplianc...	SecurityComplianceAlerts	AlertEntityGenerated	ADMIN@EDISCOSDF.ONML...		
Jun 10, 2023 10:16 PM	104.42.253.135	app@sharepoint	SharePointFileOperation	Accessed file	WKC_3_1462060_5.txt		Accessed from "IPML_WKC_3_185"
Jun 10, 2023 9:49 PM		SecurityComplianc...	SecurityComplianceAlerts	AlertEntityGenerated	7af559ce-3c8e-4e1d-b140-f...		
Jun 10, 2023 12:54 PM	104.42.253.135	app@sharepoint	SharePointFileOperation	Accessed file	WKC_3_131165_6_F1588813-...		Accessed from "PreservationHold...
Jun 10, 2023 11:32 AM	104.42.253.135	app@sharepoint	SharePointFileOperation	Accessed file	WKC_3_21058_3.txt		Accessed from "IPML_WKC_3_395"
Jun 10, 2023 11:18 AM	104.42.253.135	app@sharepoint	SharePointFileOperation	Accessed file	WKC_3_2105044_10.txt		Accessed from "IPML_WKC_3_395"
Jun 10, 2023 7:12 AM		SecurityComplianc...	SecurityComplianceAlerts	AlertTriggered	b9ca924a-fee6-f06c-9400-0...		
Jun 10, 2023 6:58 AM	104.42.253.135	app@sharepoint	SharePointFileOperation	Accessed file	WKC_3_1701093_37.txt		Accessed from "IPML_WKC_3_274"
Jun 10, 2023 6:12 AM	104.42.253.135	app@sharepoint	SharePointFileOperation	Accessed file	WKC_3_17857_4.txt		Accessed from "IPML_WKC_3_301"

Supplied portfolio screenshot - Purview Audit search results.

Search scope

User, file names, SharePoint/OneDrive, label operations, sharing, download, and sign-in-related evidence.

Timeline

Phishing -> risky sign-in -> file access -> downgrade -> clipboard -> USB -> print -> browser upload.

Retention caveat

Audit availability and retention depend on subscription, record type, and configured retention policies.

Insider Risk - Insider or Compromised Insider?

Behavioral context improves prioritization but does not determine intent without corroborating evidence.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Insider risk management > Cases > Case 449: Potential IP theft

Case 449: Potential IP theft

Active

Low

25 risk score

Resolve case

Case actions

Case overview

Alerts

User activity

Activity explorer

Forensic evidence

Content explorer

Case notes

About this case

Case information

Status

Active

Case created on

8/9/2020, 10:41:04 AM

User details

User's risk score

25/100

Email

Anony85KF-34DF

Organization or department

Manager name

Manager email

Alerts

Policy matches	Status	Severity	Time detected
Confidentiality obligation during departure	Needs review	Medium	9 months ago

Supplied portfolio screenshot - Insider Risk case investigation example.

Risk sequence

Sensitive-file access, label downgrade, multiple exfiltration channels, and unusual timing raise the score.

Privacy

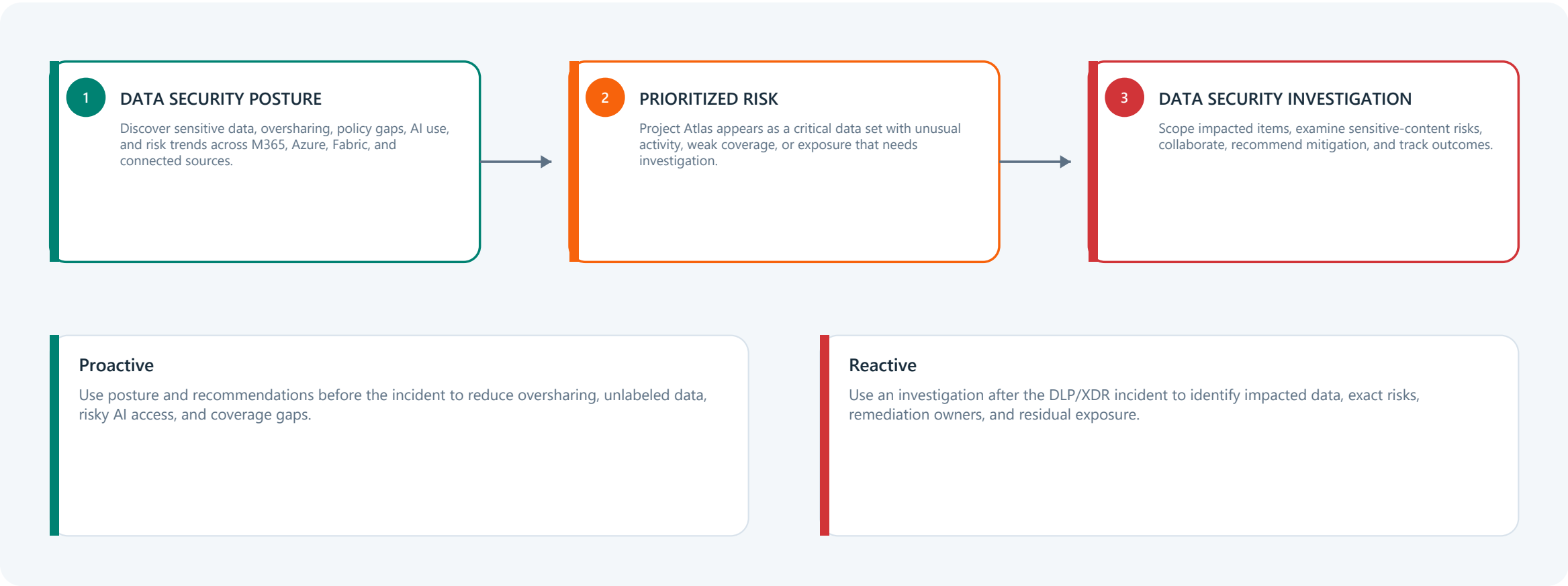
Role separation and privacy controls limit who can reveal identities and inspect content.

Sharing

When enabled, risk severity and alert context can enrich DLP and Defender XDR investigation experiences.

Purview DSPM + Data Security Investigations

DSPM prioritizes sensitive-data risk across the estate; Data Security Investigations performs deeper, item-level analysis and coordinated remediation.



Information Barriers + Communication Compliance

Segmentation limits who can collaborate; supervision detects risky communications and AI interactions under privacy-aware workflows.

PREVENT

Information Barriers

Separate Project Atlas participants from conflicting teams in supported Teams, SharePoint, and OneDrive collaboration. Define segments, policy direction, inactive testing, activation, and verification. Do not claim that IB restricts email.

DETECT

Communication Compliance

Supervise supported Exchange, Teams, Viva Engage, and generative-AI communications for confidential-project leakage, collusion, inappropriate conduct, or regulatory concerns. Use scoped reviewers and privacy controls.

QUESTION	CONTROL	EVIDENCE
Could two groups collaborate?	Information Barriers	Segment, policy, mode, allowed/blocked result
What was communicated?	Communication Compliance	Policy match, channel, reviewer action
What belongs in the security case?	Audit / IRM / eDiscovery handoff	Scoped, authorized evidence only

Compliance Manager + Secure Score - Turn Findings Into Governed Work

Operational evidence is mapped to improvement actions, owners, tests, and dates; scores guide work but are not certifications.

Evidence standard: a score is a prioritization signal. It does not by itself prove regulatory compliance, control design, or operating effectiveness.

1

Compliance Manager

Assessment templates, improvement actions, evidence, owners, test status, and compliance score

2

Microsoft Secure Score

Identity, app, device, and data security recommendations with implementation tracking

3

Secure Score for Devices

Endpoint configuration and vulnerability posture from Defender Vulnerability Management

4

Defender for Cloud

Cloud regulatory-compliance and posture signals for Azure and connected clouds

Content Explorer Case Evidence + Blast Radius

The investigation separates what Avery could access, what was actually accessed, and what was attempted for exfiltration.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

es > Case 704: Potential IP Theft

Case overview Alerts User activity Activity explorer Forensic evidence Content explorer Case notes

Examine the emails and files captured by the policies included in this case. [Learn more](#)

Group by document Edit columns

Last Updated Feb 12, 2021 (UTC)

Conditions<

+ Add a condition

Search Clear

Subject/Title	Date (UTC)	File class	Sender/Author	Sensitive info ty...
Nisivara_BB_010...	Dec 9, 2020 7:25 ...	Document	Edisco Admin	Quarter Year w/ ...
Nisivara_BB_010...	Dec 11, 2020 5:4...	Document	Edisco Admin	Quarter Year w/ ...
Nisivara_BB_010...	Dec 9, 2020 7:25 ...	Document	Edisco Admin	Quarter Year w/ ...
Nisivara_010820...	Dec 11, 2020 5:4...	Document	Edisco Admin	Quarter Year w/ ...
Nisivara_BB_010...	Jan 8, 2021 7:34 ...	Document	Edisco Admin	Quarter Year w/ ...
Nisivara_BB_010...	Dec 11, 2020 5:4...	Document	Edisco Admin	Quarter Year w/ ...

Supplied portfolio screenshot - content review within an investigation case.

Accessible

Items authorized through Avery's group and site permissions.

Accessed

Items opened, downloaded, synchronized, or read during the incident window.

Attempted

Items involved in clipboard, USB, print, or browser events; record action result per event.

From Policy Match to True-Positive Decision

A DLP alert becomes actionable only after evidence establishes identity, data, action, destination, and outcome.

DIMENSION	ENTITY	CORROBORATION	CONFIDENCE
Identity	Avery Cole	Risky sign-in after phishing	HIGH
Device	CMF-FIN-042	Suspicious endpoint behavior	HIGH
Data	Project Atlas files	PII + finance + acquisition	CRITICAL
Action	4 transfer channels	Clipboard, USB, print, browser	HIGH
Business context	No approved change	No ticket, exception, or manager approval	HIGH
Control result	Review each event	Attempted vs blocked vs overridden	REQUIRED
DISPOSITION: TRUE POSITIVE - after validating that the combined signals are not explained by authorized business activity.			

Microsoft Defender XDR - Unified Incident

Email, identity, endpoint, DLP, and insider-risk evidence becomes one attack story when integrations are enabled.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Incidents

M365D Demo 06-30-2022 Multi-stage incident involving initial access & Collection on one endpoint reported by multiple sources

M365D Demo 06-30-2022 Multi-stage incident involving Init...

Manage incident

Ask Defender Experts

Comments and history

Attack story

Alerts (13)

Devices (7)

Users (2)

Mailboxes (1)

Apps (0)

Investigations (7)

Evidence and Response (25)

Summary

Alerts

Jun 30, 2022 10:09 AM • Resolved

Suspicious sequence of exploration activities

workatond@secorp.ninja 2 Users

Jun 30, 2022 10:09 AM • Resolved

Suspicious URL clicked

workatond@secorp.ninja KDickens@secorp.ninja

Jun 30, 2022 10:09 AM • Resolved

User accessed link in ZAP-quantized email

KDickens

Jun 30, 2022 10:10 AM • Resolved

A potentially malicious URL click was detected

Karla Dickens

Jun 30, 2022 10:10 AM • Resolved

Suspicious System Owner/User Discovery

workatond@secorp.ninja 2 Users

Jun 30, 2022 10:10 AM • Resolved

Suspicious behavior by zychost.exe was observed

workatond@secorp.ninja KDickens

Incident graph

Layout

Group similar nodes

4 Processes

workatond

shdpgb.companysupport.io

MICROSOFT

KDickens@secorp.ninja

2 Users

M365D Demo 06-30-2022 Multi-stage incident involving initial access & Collection on one endpoint reported by multiple sources

Chain Event Detection

Continuous Models

See Capabilities

Manage incident

Incident details

Assigned to

tamuto@secorp.ninja onmicrosoft.com

Incident ID

7369

Classification

Not set

Categories

Initial access, Execution, Defense evasion, Credential access, Discovery, Collection

First activity

Jun 30, 2022

Last activity

Jun 30, 2022 1:01:02

Supplied portfolio screenshot - Defender XDR unified incident attack story.

Entities

User Avery Cole, device CMF-FIN-042, Project Atlas files, SharePoint site, and suspicious message.

Correlation

Defender for Office 365 + Entra identity context + Defender for Endpoint + Purview DLP/IRM.

Analyst outcome

One incident queue, shared status, common entities, and pivots into raw evidence.

Marc Lavoie | Project Atlas | Microsoft Security Stack Visual Portfolio

Microsoft Learn: MS13 MS14 MS15

51

Defender Advanced Hunting - Cross-Domain Pivoting

Hunting tests whether independent email, endpoint, identity, and cloud-activity tables support the incident hypothesis.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Advanced hunting

Help resources

Query resources report

Schema reference

New query

New query

Create new

Run query

Save

Share link

Up to 10,000 results

Last 7 days

Create detection rule

Edit in KQL

Endpoints, Apps and identities - Activity...

Remote administration from public IPs

All filters

Filters

Clear all

AND

Includes: 1 condition | 1 subgroup

Network events: SourceIpType

equals

Search

X

🗑️

OR

Includes: 5 conditions

Network events: DestinationPort

equals

22

X

🗑️

Network events: DestinationPort

equals

3889

X

🗑️

Network events: DestinationPort

equals

2900

X

🗑️

Network events: DestinationPort

equals

23

X

🗑️

Network events: DestinationPort

equals

161

X

🗑️

+ Add filter

📁 Add subgroup

+ Add filter

📁 Add subgroup

Supplied portfolio screenshot - Microsoft Defender advanced hunting query view.

Pivot keys

AccountUpn, DeviceId, SHA256, NetworkMessageId, file name, URL, and timestamp.

Hunt objective

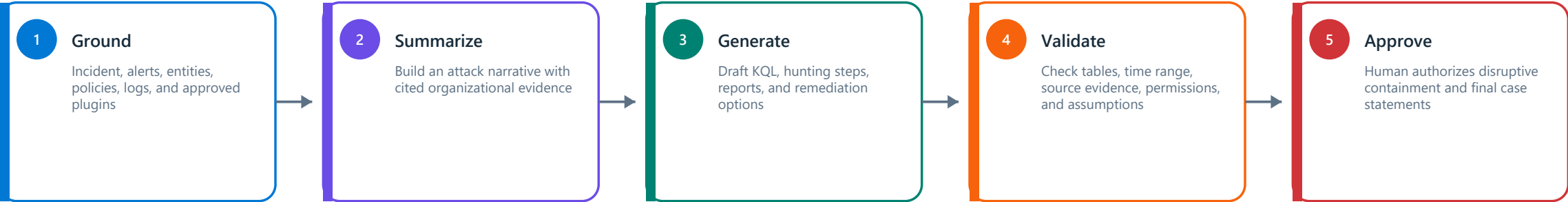
Find processes, file operations, sign-ins, and message evidence around the same session.

Evidence discipline

Keep queries, time windows, row counts, and exports with the case record.

Microsoft Security Copilot - Accelerate, Then Verify

Security Copilot assists incident response, hunting, threat intelligence, posture, Intune, Entra, and Purview workflows; the analyst remains accountable for evidence and action.



Project Atlas promptbook

Summarize incident chronology; identify conflicting evidence; propose hunts for Avery, CMF-FIN-042, Atlas files, sender domain, OAuth apps, and Azure SQL resources.

Guardrail

Treat generated text and queries as analyst work products requiring review. Preserve the source links and distinguish observed evidence from inference.

Microsoft Sentinel - Data Connectors and Telemetry Coverage

Sentinel adds Microsoft, Azure, network, and third-party context around the synchronized Defender XDR incident.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Microsoft Defender

Search

Home

Exposure management

Investigation & response

Threat intelligence

Assets

Microsoft Sentinel

Search

Threat management

Content management

Configuration

Data connectors

Analytics

Summary Rules

Watchlist

Automation

Data lake exploration

Identities

Endpoints

Email & collaboration

Cloud apps

Cloud infrastructure

Cases

Data connectors

57 Connectors 23 Connected

More content at Content Hub

Search by name or provider

Providers: All Data Types: All

Status: All

Darktrace

AIShield Bosch

Amazon Web Services Amazon

Amazon Web Services S3 Amazon

Atlassian Jira Audit (using Azure Functions) Atlassian

Azure Activity Microsoft

Azure Firewall Microsoft

Azure Key Vault Microsoft

Azure Purview (Preview) Microsoft

Azure Storage Account Microsoft

Azure Web Application Firewall (WAF) Microsoft

Cisco ASA via Legacy Agent Cisco

Cisco ASA/FTD via AMA (Preview) Microsoft

Cisco Umbrella (using Azure Functions)

Azure Firewall

Connected Status Microsoft Provider 54 Minutes Ago Last Log Received

Description

Connect to Azure Firewall. Azure Firewall is a managed, cloud-based network security service that protects your Azure Virtual Network resources. It's a fully stateful firewall as a service with built-in high availability and unrestricted cloud scalability.

Last data received 06/07/2025, 4:03:45 pm

Content source Azure Firewall Version 1.0.0

Author Microsoft Supported by Microsoft Corporation Email

Related content

Workbooks 11 Queries 20 Analytics rules templates

Data received

Go to log analytics

611 77

Open connector page

Supplied portfolio screenshot - Sentinel data connectors in the Defender portal.

Core connector

Connect incidents and alerts from Microsoft Defender XDR; enable raw events only when needed and cost-justified.

Additional context

Firewall, DNS, proxy, VPN, Azure activity, and threat intelligence can confirm destination and path.

Connector hygiene

Avoid duplicate incident creation and revalidate schemas when replacing standalone connectors.

Sentinel Analytics Rule - Project Atlas Correlation

The rule raises confidence by requiring agreement between data-loss, identity, endpoint, and high-value-asset signals.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Analytics > Analytics rule wizard

Analytics rule wizard - Create a new Scheduled rule

General

Set rule logic

Incident settings

Automated response

Review + create

Create an analytics rule that will run on your data to detect threats.

Analytics rule details

Name *

Test rule

Description

This is a test rule

Severity

Medium

MITRE ATT&CK

3 Selected

Status

Enabled

Next : Set rule logic >

Cancel

Supplied portfolio screenshot - Sentinel scheduled analytics rule wizard.

Logic

DLP alert + identity anomaly + endpoint anomaly + repeated exfiltration attempts + Project Atlas entity.

Tuning

Use time windows, thresholds, allow lists, exceptions, and an approved business-activity watchlist.

Validation

Back-test the query, record sample size, inspect false positives, and confirm the intended incident grouping.

Entity Mapping and Incident Behavior

Detection quality depends on stable entities and incident metadata, not only the KQL condition.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Analytics > Analytics rule wizard

Analytics rule wizard - Create a new Scheduled rule

General

Set rule logic

Incident settings

Automated response

Review + create

Define the logic for your new analytics rule.

Rule query

Any time details set here will be within the scope defined below in the Query scheduling fields.

SecurityEvent
| where EventID == "4625"

View query results >

Alert enhancement

> Entity mapping

> Custom details

> Alert details

Query scheduling

Run query every *

5 Hours

Lookup data from the last *

5 Hours

Start running

Automatically

At specific time (Preview)

7/1/2024 12:00 PM

Starting automatically, the rule will run every 5 hours, looking up data from last 5 hours.

< Previous

Next : Incident settings >

Cancel

Supplied portfolio screenshot - Sentinel rule entity mapping and incident settings.

Map

Account -> Avery UPN; Host -> CMF-FIN-042; File -> name/SHA256; URL/IP -> destination evidence.

Group

Group alerts when user, device, and Project Atlas data overlap inside the chosen window.

Automate

Apply tags and notifications automatically; gate disruptive containment actions for analyst approval.

Marc Lavoie | Project Atlas | Microsoft Security Stack Visual Portfolio

Microsoft Learn: MS16

56

Sentinel Incident - Enterprise-Wide Corroboration

The synchronized incident joins Defender's attack story to network and Azure telemetry used by the wider SOC.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Home > Microsoft Sentinel | Incidents >



Initial access incident involving one user

Incident ID 337075

 Refresh

 Delete incident

 Logs

 Tasks

 Activity log

High Severity

▼

 New Status

▼

 Unassigned Owner

▼

«

Overview

Entities

Supplied portfolio screenshot - synchronized Microsoft Sentinel incident.

Sync

Title, severity, owner, status, comments, tags, and related fields synchronize according to the active integration.

Investigate

Use entity pages, incident graph, bookmarks, logs, and deep links back to Defender XDR.

Outcome

Incident severity becomes Critical only after cross-platform evidence supports the claim.

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Microsoft Learn: MS16

57

Sentinel UEBA + Watchlists + Threat Intelligence

Behavior, business context, and threat indicators raise fidelity without replacing the underlying alert and event evidence.

False-positive test: approved business ticket + known destination + expected device + valid exception should reduce confidence; their absence should be recorded.

1

UEBA

Compare Avery's activity to normal user and peer behavior; use entity insights as context, not proof.

2

Watchlists

Maintain approved USB exceptions, change tickets, Project Atlas assets, VIPs, and sanctioned destinations.

3

Threat intelligence

Match sender domains, URLs, IPs, and hashes against curated and organizational indicators.

4

Entity pages

Pivot through user, host, IP, URL, file, cloud resource, and account relationships.

Content Hub + Workbooks + Data Lake + SOC Optimization

Sentinel is also a content, visualization, data, and operations platform - not only an incident queue.

Accuracy rule: document which Sentinel portal experience, connector mode, tables, retention tier, and data-lake features are actually enabled.

1 Content hub

Install and version Microsoft and partner solutions, connectors, rules, workbooks, and playbooks

2 Workbooks

Visualize Project Atlas incidents, DLP channels, identities, assets, and response status

3 Data lake

Retain and explore high-volume security data; use lake-aware workbooks and analytics where applicable

4 SOC optimization

Identify coverage gaps, unused data, cost opportunities, and MITRE coverage improvements

5 Repositories / IaC

Version detection content and deployment artifacts with review, testing, and rollback

6 Health + audit

Monitor connector, rule, playbook, and ingestion health; preserve operational changes

Azure Logic Apps Playbook - Guarded Response Automation

Automation accelerates repeatable work while disruptive containment remains approval-aware.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Home > Microsoft Sentinel > Microsoft Sentinel > Notify-GovernanceComplianceTeam >

Logic Apps Designer

Save Discard Run Trigger Designer Code view Parameters Templates

When Azure Sentinel incident creation rule was triggered (Preview)

For each

Select an output from previous stepsAlerts x

Post message in a chat or channel

Post asFlow bot

Post inChannel

Connected to rsanchez@contoso.com. Change connection.

Send an email (V2) 2

Body

Font 12 B I U

Governance & Compliance Team,

Supplied portfolio screenshot - Azure Logic Apps playbook designer.

- Automatic**
Assign case, add Project Atlas tag, notify incident commander, create ticket, and preserve links.
- Approval gate**
Session revocation, account disablement, device isolation, and broad access removal can interrupt the business.
- Auditability**
Record trigger, incident ID, approver, action result, failure branch, retry, and rollback path.

Containment and Remediation Matrix

Identity, endpoint, data, collaboration, and legal teams act in parallel with explicit owners and verification checks.

DOMAIN	ACTION	OWNER	VERIFY
Identity	Revoke sessions; reset credentials; review MFA/OAuth	Entra response owner	Fresh sign-in requires approved auth
Endpoint	Isolate CMF-FIN-042; collect package; scan	Security operator	Isolation state + Action center success
Data	Validate labels, encryption, links, and DLP events	Information Protection / DLP	No unexpected share or label removal
Collaboration	Review SharePoint/Teams members and guest access	Site owner + security	Permissions match approved groups
Threat	Remediate phishing email, URL, and related messages	Defender Office analyst	Malicious cluster remediated
Legal	Create case; preserve relevant custodians and sources	eDiscovery Manager	Hold/search status recorded

Microsoft Purview eDiscovery - Preserve the Case

Security operations hands a scoped, time-bounded evidence request to the legal investigation workflow.

PORTAL EVIDENCE

Advanced eDiscovery > JW.6.29.2021.LargeCase

Overview

Data sources

Collections

Review sets

Communications

Hold

Processing

Exports

...

Review sets help you manage content that you've collected from Office 365 and non-Office 365 data sources, such as documents, email, and chat messages. You can collaborate with other case members to analyze, query, review, tag, and export content. [Learn more](#)

+ Add review set

Open review set

Export

Refresh

6 items

Search

Name	Status	Size (GB)	Created by
Teams private channel irrep	ready	0.001/1024	admin@edbig.onmicrosoft.com
Teams Private Channel Irrep	ready	0/1024	admin@edbig.onmicrosoft.com
Teams Channel Icecream	ready	0.001/1024	admin@edbig.onmicrosoft.com
Teams 1-N Pancake	ready	0.631/1024	admin@edbig.onmicrosoft.com
Teams 1-1 Waffles	ready	0.128/1024	admin@edbig.onmicrosoft.com
Teams private channel irrep	ready	0/1024	admin@edbig.onmicrosoft.com

Supplied portfolio screenshot - eDiscovery review-set example.

Case

PROJECT ATLAS SECURITY INCIDENT with named custodians, time window, issues, and access controls.

Sources

Exchange, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams, M365 Groups, and relevant incident-response communications.

Proof

Document holds, searches, collection status, review set, exports, and chain-of-custody decisions.

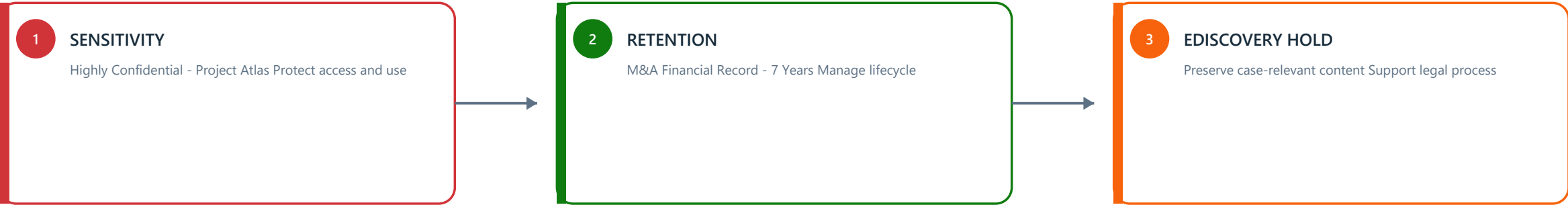
Marc Lavoie | Project Atlas | Microsoft Security Stack Visual Portfolio

Microsoft Learn: MS19

62

Retention and Legal Preservation - Different Purposes

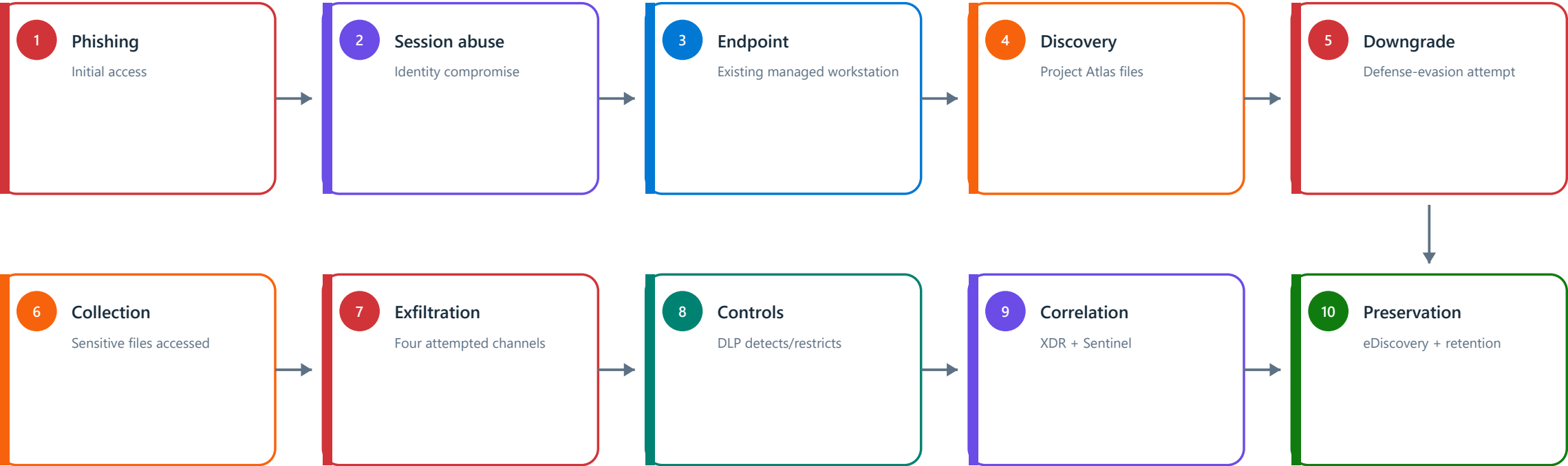
The security incident does not silently replace the organization's record-keeping or legal-hold obligations.



CONTROL	QUESTION	PROJECT ATLAS OUTCOME
Sensitivity label	How should the item be protected?	Classification, encryption, marking, DLP
Retention label	How long should the record be retained?	Seven-year M&A record schedule
eDiscovery hold	What must be preserved for this matter?	Scoped case preservation

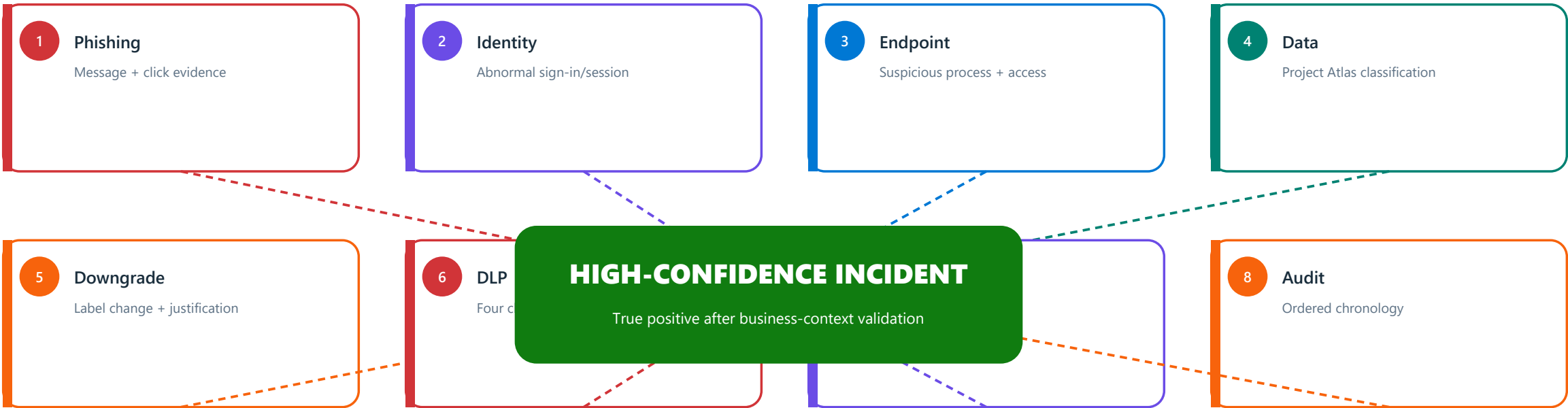
Attack Chain and Root-Cause Determination

The final narrative connects initial access to containment without overstating which exfiltration attempts succeeded.



Why the Incident Becomes High Confidence

No single alert proves the full attack. Confidence emerges when independent telemetry agrees.



Final Incident Disposition - Project Atlas

The closure statement is concise, testable, and careful about what telemetry proved.

Control effectiveness: document each monitored transfer as attempted, allowed, overridden, or blocked - event by event.

STATUS Contained	SEVERITY Critical	CLASSIFICATION True Positive
INITIAL ACCESS Phishing	IDENTITY Compromised	DEVICE CMF-FIN-042
DATA Highly Confidential - Project Atlas	EXFILTRATION Multiple attempts detected	LEGAL eDiscovery case initiated

How Every Data-Protection Component Contributes - 1 of 3

The contribution is defined by function, evidence, and handoff - not by whether the product produced a separate alert.

COMPONENT	FUNCTION	EVIDENCE
Data Map	Locate and classify enterprise data	Classified columns and lineage
Sensitive Information Types	Detect structured identifiers	Match type, count, confidence
Custom SIT	Recognize Atlas customer IDs	ATL-CUST pattern match
Trainable classifiers	Recognize semantic document types	Classifier match
Sensitivity labels	Classify and protect content	Label ID, priority, settings
Publishing policies	Deliver labels to scoped users	Policy assignment
Default / mandatory label	Reduce unlabeled content	Client policy behavior
Downgrade justification	Capture classification reduction	Actor, time, reason
Client auto-labeling	Detect during Office use	Recommendation/application
Service auto-labeling	Classify stored M365 content	Simulation and match
Content Explorer	Locate affected items	Inventory and location
Activity Explorer	Show label and DLP activity	Ordered event timeline
Fabric / Power BI	Carry classification into analytics	Label and export path

How Every Security and Investigation Component Contributes - 2 of 3

Identity, endpoint, threat, SIEM, and legal capabilities complete the information-centered defense-in-depth model.

COMPONENT	FUNCTION	EVIDENCE
SharePoint / Teams labels	Govern collaboration containers	Privacy/sharing settings
Entra auth context	Protect a high-value resource	CA context evaluation
Intune	Supply device-compliance signal	Compliance state
Microsoft 365 Copilot	Honor authorization and protection	Access/usage-right outcome
Endpoint DLP	Control endpoint transfer channels	Action + result + destination
Purview DLP	Detect sensitive-data policy violations	Alert and event metadata
Insider Risk	Add behavioral user-risk context	Alert/case severity
Audit	Reconstruct user/service activity	Search results and exports
Defender Office / Endpoint	Establish threat and device story	Email + process evidence
Defender XDR	Correlate the multi-domain incident	Incident, alerts, entities
Sentinel	Add SIEM correlation and automation	Rules, incidents, playbooks
eDiscovery	Preserve and review relevant content	Case, hold, collection
Retention	Maintain records lifecycle	Label/policy and disposition

How the Extended Enterprise Stack Contributes - 3 of 3

The extended capabilities close identity, SaaS, cloud, exposure, AI, assurance, and OT gaps around the same Project Atlas scenario.

COMPONENT	FUNCTION	EVIDENCE
Defender for Identity	Detect hybrid identity attacks	Sensor/API alert and identity context
Defender for Cloud Apps	Protect SaaS sessions, files, and OAuth apps	Activity, policy, app, and session result
Vulnerability Management	Prioritize and track endpoint weaknesses	Recommendation and reassessment
Exposure Management	Map critical assets and attack paths	Exposure graph and remediation
Threat Intelligence	Enrich domains, URLs, IPs, and hashes	Reputation and relationship evidence
Defender for Cloud	Protect cloud posture, code, and workloads	Recommendation, alert, and cloud resource
Defender for IoT	Establish OT/IoT impact boundary	Site, device, risk, and incident
Security Copilot	Accelerate triage, hunting, and reporting	Prompt/session plus validated sources
Entra ID Governance / PIM	Time-bound project and admin access	Package, review, activation, expiration
Workload ID	Secure pipelines and automation identities	Service-principal sign-in and credentials
Global Secure Access	Identity-aware internet/private access	Traffic log and CA result
DSPM / DSI	Prioritize and investigate data risk	Risk insight, scope, examination, action
IB / Communication Compliance	Segment and supervise collaboration	Policy, event, reviewer result
Compliance Manager / scores	Govern improvement work and assurance	Action, owner, test, score, evidence
Sentinel platform services	Content, workbooks, lake, and SOC optimization	Version, health, usage, and output

How to Explain This Project in an Interview

Lead with the data story, then explain how each product answers a different investigation question.

”

I designed Project Atlas around the lifecycle of regulated acquisition data. Purview Data Map and classification identify the data; labels, publishing, and DLP protect it; Entra and Intune govern access; Defender establishes the phishing and endpoint story; XDR and Sentinel correlate the incident; and Audit, Insider Risk, eDiscovery, and retention support investigation and preservation. The key result is not that every product alerted. It is that each control supplied a distinct fact needed to classify, contain, and prove the incident.



Safe Lab Build and Evidence Register

A portfolio becomes stronger when every claim has a reproducible test, captured output, and cleanup path.

Recommended portfolio artifact set: architecture + policy exports + event timeline + queries + incident notes + cleanup verification.

1. TENANT + LICENSE Record tenant type, licenses, regions, and enabled integrations.	2. TEST IDENTITIES Use fictional accounts, scoped groups, and least-privilege role assignments.
3. SYNTHETIC DATA Use non-real SSNs, bank data, customer IDs, messages, and destinations.	4. POLICY MODE Begin with simulation, audit, or report-only; document the promotion gate.
5. EVIDENCE Capture policy version, screenshot, event ID, UTC time, actor, device, and result.	6. RESPONSE Test approval branches and verify session revocation, isolation, and permissions.
7. CLEANUP Remove test data, revoke temporary roles, close cases, and verify policy scope.	8. CLAIM REVIEW Mark each result as configured, observed, blocked, simulated, or not tested.

Official Microsoft Documentation - 1 of 7

Current Microsoft Learn pages used to validate the architecture. Portal names, licensing, and preview status can change.

MS01	Create and publish sensitivity labels https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/create-sensitivity-labels
MS02	Automatically apply a sensitivity label to Microsoft 365 data https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/apply-sensitivity-label-automatically
MS03	Labeling activities available in Activity explorer https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/data-classification-activity-explorer-available-events
MS04	Sensitivity labels in Microsoft Purview Data Map https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/data-map-sensitivity-labels
MS05	Data classification in Microsoft Purview Data Map https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/data-map-classification
MS06	Information protection in Microsoft Fabric https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/fabric/governance/information-protection
MS07	Sensitivity-label inheritance from data sources in Power BI https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/fabric/governance/service-security-sensitivity-label-inheritance-from-data-sources

Validate current licensing, portal navigation, support matrix, and preview status before presenting any control as deployed.

Official Microsoft Documentation - 2 of 7

Current Microsoft Learn pages used to validate the architecture. Portal names, licensing, and preview status can change.

MS08	Sensitivity labels and Microsoft 365 Copilot https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/sensitivity-labels
MS09	Authentication context in Conditional Access https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/identity/conditional-access/concept-conditional-access-cloud-apps
MS10	Conditional Access with Intune compliance policies https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/intune/device-security/conditional-access-integration/overview
MS11	Learn about Endpoint data loss prevention https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/endpoint-dlp-learn-about
MS12	Get started with the DLP Alerts dashboard https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/dlp-alerts-dashboard-get-started
MS13	Investigate DLP alerts with Microsoft Defender XDR https://learn.microsoft.com/en-ca/defender-xdr/dlp-investigate-alerts-defender
MS14	Share Insider Risk Management data with other solutions https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/insider-risk-management-settings-share-data

Validate current licensing, portal navigation, support matrix, and preview status before presenting any control as deployed.

Official Microsoft Documentation - 3 of 7

Current Microsoft Learn pages used to validate the architecture. Portal names, licensing, and preview status can change.

MS15	Advanced hunting across devices, emails, apps, and identities https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-xdr/advanced-hunting-query-emails-devices
MS16	Defender XDR integration with Microsoft Sentinel https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/sentinel/microsoft-365-defender-sentinel-integration
MS17	Stream Microsoft Defender XDR data to Microsoft Sentinel https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/sentinel/connect-microsoft-365-defender
MS18	Microsoft Purview Audit overview https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/audit-solutions-overview
MS19	Learn about eDiscovery https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/edisc
MS20	Data lifecycle and records management overview https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/manage-data-governance
MS21	Email analysis in Defender for Office 365 investigations https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-office-365/email-analysis-investigations

Validate current licensing, portal navigation, support matrix, and preview status before presenting any control as deployed.

Official Microsoft Documentation - 4 of 7

Current Microsoft Learn pages used to validate the architecture. Portal names, licensing, and preview status can change.

MS22	Respond to devices in Microsoft Defender for Endpoint https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/security/defender-endpoint/respond-machine-alerts
MS23	Manage and respond to Defender for Cloud alerts https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/defender-for-cloud/managing-and-responding-alerts
MS24	Microsoft Defender for Identity overview https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-for-identity/what-is
MS25	Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps overview https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-cloud-apps/what-is-defender-for-cloud-apps
MS26	What is Microsoft Defender Vulnerability Management https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-vulnerability-management/defender-vulnerability-management
MS27	What is Microsoft Security Exposure Management https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/security-exposure-management/microsoft-security-exposure-management
MS28	Microsoft Threat Intelligence in Microsoft Defender XDR https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender/threat-intelligence/what-is-microsoft-defender-threat-intelligence-defender-ti

Validate current licensing, portal navigation, support matrix, and preview status before presenting any control as deployed.

Official Microsoft Documentation - 5 of 7

Current Microsoft Learn pages used to validate the architecture. Portal names, licensing, and preview status can change.

MS29	What is Microsoft Defender for Cloud https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/defender-for-cloud/defender-for-cloud-introduction
MS30	Microsoft Defender portal and unified security operations https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/unified-secops-platform/overview-defender-portal
MS31	What is Microsoft Security Copilot https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/copilot/security/microsoft-security-copilot
MS32	What is Microsoft Entra https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/fundamentals/what-is-entra
MS33	Entitlement management overview https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/id-governance/entitlement-management-overview
MS34	Access reviews overview https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/id-governance/access-reviews-overview
MS35	Get started with Privileged Identity Management https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/id-governance/privileged-identity-management/pim-getting-started

Validate current licensing, portal navigation, support matrix, and preview status before presenting any control as deployed.

Official Microsoft Documentation - 6 of 7

Current Microsoft Learn pages used to validate the architecture. Portal names, licensing, and preview status can change.

MS36	How Microsoft Purview solutions work together https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/purview-where-to-start
MS37	Microsoft Purview Data Security Posture Management https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/data-security-posture-management-learn-about
MS38	Microsoft Purview Data Security Investigations https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/data-security-investigations
MS39	Microsoft Purview Information Barriers https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/information-barriers
MS40	Microsoft Purview Communication Compliance https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/communication-compliance
MS41	Get started with Microsoft Purview Compliance Manager https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/purview/compliance-manager-setup
MS42	Microsoft Entra Workload ID https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/workload-id/

Validate current licensing, portal navigation, support matrix, and preview status before presenting any control as deployed.

Official Microsoft Documentation - 7 of 7

Current Microsoft Learn pages used to validate the architecture. Portal names, licensing, and preview status can change.

MS43	What is Global Secure Access https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/entra/global-secure-access/overview-what-is-global-secure-access
MS44	Microsoft Defender for IoT https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/defender-for-iot/
MS45	Microsoft Sentinel Data Lake workbooks https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/sentinel/datalake/workbooks-for-data-lake
MS46	Microsoft Windows security documentation https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/security/

Validate current licensing, portal navigation, support matrix, and preview status before presenting any control as deployed.